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ADMINISTRATIVE POLICY

ICT, ACCOUNTING AND OTHER COURSES THAT MAY BE APPROVED BY LEGAL EDUCATION BODIES (TVETA, KASNEB AND NITA)

FOR ADMINISTRATIVE USE AND EXTERNAL/PUBLIC RELATIONS ASSESSMENT

RURALNET TRAINING COLLEGE | P. O.BOX 4 – 40606, UGUNJA

RURALNET TRAINING COLLEGE
ADMINISTRATIVE AND INSTITUTIONAL POLICY MANUAL

Applicable Programmes: Information and Communication Technology (ICT), Accounting, and other approved programmes.

Institution: RuralNet Training College

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Document Control Statement: This manual shall be maintained by the designated College office. Amendments shall be documented and approved through the established institutional procedures. Printed or downloaded copies may become outdated; users should confirm that they are consulting the current approved version.

DECLARATION AND INSTITUTIONAL COMMITMENT

RuralNet Training College declares its commitment to maintaining a well-organized, accountable, transparent, professional, and learner-centred institution.

The College recognizes that effective administration, quality education, responsible financial management, proper use of resources, staff professionalism, student welfare, and continuous improvement are essential to achieving its institutional objectives.

Through this Administrative and Institutional Policy Manual, the College establishes a common framework to guide decision-making, define responsibilities, standardize procedures, promote ethical conduct, and ensure consistency in the management of its academic and administrative activities.

The College commits itself to implementing the provisions of this manual in a manner that supports quality training, equitable treatment, responsible management, innovation, and the development of competent graduates in ICT, Accounting, and other approved areas of training.

All staff members, students, and other persons to whom particular provisions apply shall be expected to understand and comply with the relevant requirements of this manual.

This declaration represents the institutional commitment of RuralNet Training College, subject to formal approval by the authorized College authority and compliance with applicable laws and regulatory requirements.

Signed on behalf of RuralNet Training College:

Name: _____

Designation: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Official Stamp: _____

APPROVAL AND AUTHORIZATION

This Administrative and Institutional Policy Manual has been prepared to provide a structured framework for the governance, administration, academic delivery, and operational management of RuralNet Training College.

Upon formal approval, the manual shall serve as an official reference for the administration of the College and the conduct of activities covered by its provisions.

The approving authority confirms that the manual has been reviewed and authorized for implementation, subject to applicable legislation, regulatory requirements, institutional obligations, and any other governing instruments that take precedence.

Name of Approving Authority: _____

Designation: _____

Signature: _____

Date of Approval: _____

Official Stamp: _____

Implementation Authorization

Effective from the date indicated below, the designated College management office shall coordinate the communication, implementation, monitoring, and periodic review of this manual.

Effective Date: _____

Responsible Officer: _____

Designation: _____

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

RuralNet Training College acknowledges the importance of collective responsibility in developing and maintaining effective institutional policies.

The preparation and implementation of this manual depend on the cooperation of College management, academic staff, administrative personnel, students, industry partners, and other relevant stakeholders.

The College recognizes the contribution of all persons involved in identifying institutional needs, establishing administrative procedures, promoting academic quality, strengthening student support, and improving the overall learning environment.

The manual reflects the College's commitment to establishing clear standards of conduct, responsibility, accountability, and service delivery across its operations.

RuralNet Training College further acknowledges that this manual is a working institutional document that must evolve in response to operational experience, stakeholder feedback, technological developments, changes in applicable law, and emerging educational requirements.

PREFACE

Education and technical training play an important role in developing practical skills, promoting innovation, supporting entrepreneurship, and preparing individuals for employment and self-employment.

RuralNet Training College recognizes the importance of equipping learners with relevant ICT, Accounting, and business-related competencies that respond to the needs of employers, enterprises, public institutions, and the wider community.

To achieve these objectives, the College requires a clear and consistent framework for institutional administration, academic management, student affairs, financial accountability, resource management, quality assurance, research, innovation, and stakeholder engagement.

This Administrative and Institutional Policy Manual has therefore been developed to guide the day-to-day operations and long-term development of the College.

It provides a common reference for management, staff, students, and other relevant stakeholders, clarifying institutional expectations, responsibilities, procedures, and standards.

The manual is intended to promote professional conduct, consistency in decision-making, effective communication, responsible use of resources, quality teaching and learning, and continuous institutional improvement.

College management shall support the implementation of this manual through appropriate communication, staff orientation, resource allocation, monitoring, and periodic review.

The successful implementation of these policies will depend on the commitment of all stakeholders to the College's mission, values, and institutional objectives.

FOREWORD

The development of RuralNet Training College reflects the importance of accessible, relevant, and practical education in preparing learners for the opportunities and challenges of a changing technological and economic environment.

As the College continues to develop its ICT and Accounting programmes, effective institutional administration becomes essential to maintaining quality, accountability, and public confidence.

This Administrative and Institutional Policy Manual provides a structured foundation for the management of academic and non-academic activities. It defines the procedures and standards through which the College seeks to maintain professionalism, protect institutional resources, support students and staff, and strengthen relationships with industry and the community.

The manual is intended to support informed decision-making at every level of the institution. It also provides a basis for evaluating institutional performance and identifying areas that require improvement.

All members of the College community are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the provisions relevant to their responsibilities and to contribute constructively to their implementation.

Through consistent application, periodic review, and stakeholder cooperation, RuralNet Training College seeks to strengthen its institutional capacity and provide a supportive environment for learning, innovation, professional development, and responsible service.

Signed:

Name: _____

Designation: _____

Date: _____

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

The following abbreviations may be used throughout this manual. Additional terms may be included where necessary.

Abbreviation	Meaning
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training
QA	Quality Assurance
HR	Human Resources
ICTS	Information and Communication Technology Services
LMS	Learning Management System
IT	Information Technology
IP	Intellectual Property
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
PPE	Personal Protective Equipment
E-waste	Electronic Waste
KIPI	Kenya Industrial Property Institute
KNEC	Kenya National Examinations Council
CDACC	Curriculum Development, Assessment and Certification Council

DEFINITION OF KEY TERMS

For the purposes of this manual, the following terms shall have the meanings assigned to them below, unless otherwise stated

Academic Staff: Lecturers, trainers, instructors, and other personnel responsible for teaching, assessment, academic supervision, or related educational activities.

Administration: The coordination and management of institutional activities, personnel, records, resources, communication, and operational procedures.

Authorized Officer: A person formally assigned or delegated the authority to perform a particular institutional function.

College Management: The persons or management structure responsible for the administration, coordination, and oversight of the College.

Compliance: Adherence to approved institutional policies, applicable laws, regulatory requirements, and authorized procedures.

Confidential Information: Information that must be protected from unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, or distribution because of its nature, legal requirements, or institutional obligations.

Continuous Improvement: The systematic process of identifying weaknesses, implementing corrective actions, and improving institutional performance over time.

Department: An academic, administrative, or operational unit established to perform specific functions within the College.

Digital Learning Resources: Electronic materials, software, platforms, databases, and other digital tools used to support teaching, learning, assessment, and research.

Industry Attachment: A structured period of workplace learning intended to help students apply acquired knowledge and skills in a relevant work environment.

Institutional Policy: An approved statement of principles, rules, responsibilities, and procedures that guides decisions and activities within the College.

Learning Resources: Textbooks, reference materials, software, equipment, digital resources, and other materials used for teaching, learning, research, and assessment.

Management: The authorized leadership responsible for implementing institutional objectives, supervising operations, and making decisions within its approved mandate.

Policy Manual: The official document containing approved institutional policies and related guidance.

Quality Assurance: Planned and systematic activities intended to maintain and improve the quality of institutional operations, training, assessment, and services.

Research: A systematic investigation undertaken to develop knowledge, examine a problem, test a solution, or improve professional practice.

Student: A person duly admitted or registered to undertake an approved programme offered by the College.

Stakeholder: A person or organization that has an interest in, contributes to, or is affected by the activities of the College.

Policy Review: A formal assessment of an existing policy to determine whether it remains appropriate, effective, compliant, and relevant.

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP): A documented set of instructions describing how a particular task or process should be performed.

Authorized Governing Authority: The person, committee, board, proprietor, or other body legally or institutionally empowered to approve policies and make decisions for the College.

INTRODUCTION TO THE MANUAL

1. Background

RuralNet Training College is a training institution focused on providing practical education and skills development in Information and Communication Technology, Accounting, and other approved areas of training.

The College recognizes that quality education requires not only effective classroom instruction but also sound administration, competent personnel, appropriate learning resources, responsible financial management, effective student support, and consistent institutional procedures.

As the College develops its programmes and services, a formal policy framework is necessary to guide operations, clarify responsibilities, reduce inconsistencies, and support accountability.

This Administrative and Institutional Policy Manual establishes the principal policies that guide the College's academic, administrative, financial, operational, and stakeholder-related activities.

2. Purpose of the Manual

The purpose of this manual is to provide an authoritative institutional reference for the management and operation of RuralNet Training College.

Specifically, the manual seeks to:

1. Establish clear policies and procedures for the effective administration of the College.
2. Define the responsibilities and expectations of management, staff, students, and relevant stakeholders.
3. Promote consistency, fairness, transparency, and accountability in institutional decision-making.
4. Support quality teaching, learning, assessment, research, and practical training.
5. Protect College resources, information, facilities, and institutional interests.
6. Promote ethical conduct, professional standards, and respect for the rights of others.
7. Improve coordination among academic, administrative, and operational departments.
8. Provide a framework for monitoring institutional performance and implementing improvements.
9. Support compliance with applicable laws, regulatory requirements, and relevant professional standards.
10. Guide the College's long-term institutional development and sustainability.

3. Scope of the Manual

This manual applies to the management and operation of RuralNet Training College and covers the activities, personnel, programmes, and services identified in its individual chapters.

Its provisions apply to College management, academic staff, administrative staff, students, and other persons where the relevant policy specifically applies to them.

The manual covers institutional governance and administration, human resource management, academic administration, student affairs, ICT infrastructure, finance and procurement, quality assurance, health and safety, communication and public relations, library services, research and innovation, industry linkages, and monitoring and evaluation.

The manual shall be read alongside applicable laws, regulatory requirements, programme-specific rules, employment agreements, approved financial procedures, and other relevant institutional documents.

4. Institutional Objectives

In implementing this manual, RuralNet Training College seeks to:

- Provide relevant, practical, and quality training in ICT, Accounting, and other approved programmes.
- Develop students' technical, analytical, professional, and entrepreneurial competencies.
- Maintain effective administrative systems and accountable institutional leadership.
- Promote ethical behaviour, fairness, discipline, and respect within the College community.
- Ensure the responsible use and maintenance of institutional facilities and resources.
- Strengthen collaboration with employers, industry partners, educational institutions, and the community.
- Support research, innovation, digital skills development, and problem-solving.
- Monitor institutional performance and continuously improve educational and administrative services.

5. Institutional Vision, Mission, and Core Values

The following statements should be confirmed and formally approved by College management before publication.

5.1 Vision

To be a recognized provider of accessible, practical, and quality technical and business training that empowers learners to participate effectively in the digital economy and wider world of work.

5.2 Mission

To provide relevant, affordable, and practical education in ICT, Accounting, and related fields through effective instruction, skills development, innovation, industry engagement, and responsible institutional management.

5.3 Core Values

Integrity: Upholding honesty, accountability, transparency, and ethical conduct.

Professionalism: Maintaining competence, discipline, respect, and high standards of service.

Quality: Pursuing excellence in teaching, learning, assessment, administration, and student support.

Innovation: Encouraging creativity, technological advancement, practical problem-solving, and entrepreneurship.

Inclusivity: Promoting fair treatment and reasonable access to learning opportunities.

Accountability: Taking responsibility for decisions, actions, resources, and institutional outcomes.

Teamwork: Encouraging cooperation, communication, and shared responsibility.

Continuous Improvement: Learning from experience, feedback, evaluation, and emerging developments.

6. Policy Framework

The policies in this manual establish the general institutional standards that guide the College's operations.

Each policy shall be interpreted in conjunction with the other relevant chapters and applicable supporting procedures. Where a policy requires more detailed instructions, the College may issue forms, guidelines, departmental procedures, or standard operating procedures.

No departmental procedure shall be used to contradict an approved institutional policy or applicable law.

7. Implementation of the Manual

College management shall coordinate implementation through the relevant departments and designated officers.

Implementation shall include:

- Communicating approved policies to affected persons.
- Providing orientation and guidance on policy requirements.
- Assigning responsibilities for implementation and monitoring.
- Making reasonable arrangements for the resources required.
- Maintaining relevant records and documentation.
- Monitoring compliance and addressing implementation challenges.
- Reviewing policies and procedures when necessary.

Heads of departments and other responsible officers shall ensure that relevant policies are understood and applied within their areas of responsibility.

8. Interpretation and Application

The manual shall be interpreted in a manner that promotes its purpose, consistency, fairness, and compliance with applicable requirements.

Where a provision is unclear, the matter shall be referred to College management or the authorized officer for clarification.

Where two institutional provisions appear inconsistent, management shall determine the appropriate interpretation, taking into account the scope and purpose of the provisions and any applicable legal or regulatory requirements.

Nothing in this manual shall be interpreted as authorizing an action prohibited by applicable law or as removing a right or obligation that must be respected under law.

9. Relationship with Other Institutional Documents

This manual shall operate alongside other approved institutional documents, which may include:

- Student handbook.
- Staff handbook and employment policies.
- Academic regulations and assessment procedures.
- Financial and procurement procedures.
- Health, safety, and emergency procedures.
- ICT acceptable-use and information security procedures.
- Data protection and records management procedures.
- Internship and industrial attachment guidelines.
- Programme-specific rules and awarding-body requirements.

Where an issue is governed by a more specific approved procedure, that procedure shall be read together with this manual, subject to applicable law and the College's approval framework.

10. Communication and Accessibility

The College shall make the manual available to relevant staff and other authorized stakeholders through appropriate means.

Access may be provided through printed copies, electronic documents, the institutional website, staff communication channels, or other approved platforms.

The College may provide summaries or orientation materials to help users understand important provisions. Such summaries shall not replace the official approved policy text.

Users shall be informed when significant revisions affect their duties, rights, responsibilities, or procedures.

11. Review and Amendment

This manual shall be reviewed periodically in accordance with Chapter 13 and any applicable legal, regulatory, or institutional requirements.

Amendments may be proposed following monitoring and evaluation, audit findings, stakeholder feedback, technological developments, changes in applicable law, or changes in institutional operations.

All amendments shall be documented, reviewed, and approved by the authorized authority before being incorporated into the official manual.

12. Effective Date

This manual shall take effect on the date formally approved by the authorized governing authority or College management, provided the approving body has the necessary authority to do so.

The effective date shall be recorded on the document control and approval pages.

13. Responsibility for Implementation

Overall responsibility for implementing this manual rests with the authorized College management structure.

Each department and staff member shall implement the provisions relevant to their responsibilities, while students and other stakeholders shall comply with the provisions applicable to them.

The College shall promote a culture in which policies serve as practical tools for quality, accountability, effective administration, and continuous improvement.

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- Monitor and troubleshoot hardware, software, and network issues. 8
- Perform regular system updates, backups, and data recovery operations. 8
- Configure and secure routers, switches, firewalls, and Wi-Fi access points. 8
- Provide technical support and user assistance for ICT systems. 8
- Manage and administer servers, email systems, and user accounts. 8
- Implement cybersecurity measures to protect data and systems. 8
- Conduct ICT audits and recommend system improvements. 8
- Develop and enforce ICT policies, standards, and procedures. 8
- Maintain records of ICT assets, licenses, and configurations. 8
- Manage institutional websites, online portals, and databases. 8
- Offer advice on ICT solutions, procurement, and system upgrades. 8
- Conduct staff or client training on ICT tools and best practices. 8
- Participate in ICT project planning, budgeting, and implementation. 8
- Research and recommend emerging technologies to improve efficiency. 8
- Ensure compliance with data protection and ICT security regulations. 8

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CHAPTER ONE:
POLICY FRAMEWORK

Introduction

Administrative policy refers to a set of **rules, principles, and guidelines** established by Ruralnet Training College to direct and regulate its **internal operations, management, and decision-making processes**. It is the **framework that guides how things should be done** at ruralnet to ensure order, efficiency, and accountability during daily operations by both management, staff and students/clients.

By using this manual, Ruralnet Training College will be able to successfully;

Manage its resources (human, financial, physical, and technological)

- Deliver its services
- Maintain discipline and performance
- Ensure compliance with laws and institutional standards

Our policy scope

The table below gives our manual scope summary

Component	Focus Area
Policy Framework	Purpose, vision, scope
Governance and institutional structure	Management structure
Human Resource	Staffing, conduct, development
Academic Administration	Teaching, exams, curriculum
Student Affairs	Admission, welfare, discipline
ICT Infrastructure	Systems, labs, security
Finance & Procurement	Budgeting, purchases, accountability
Quality Assurance	Evaluation, accreditation
Health & Safety	Safety and environmental policies
Communication	PR, feedback, information sharing
Library & Learning	Academic resource management
Research & Industry Links	Innovation and collaboration
Monitoring & Review	Evaluation and improvement

Name and Aim

Ruralnet Training College (RICT) is an institution aimed at providing ICT education to the rural population located in Siaya County in a town called Ugunja along Busia-Kisumu highway, as well distant people through online training. The Academy aims to bridge the digital divide between rural and urban areas by offering high-quality training to the rural population. The Academy offers a range of courses, including computer basics, web design, programming, digital marketing, data analysis and KASNEB courses.

Vision and Vision Statement

1. Mission

Ruralnet Training College's (Our mission is to understand what our students and businesses hope to achieve and dedicate our computer training and development to the fulfillment of those goals.

The computer training provided is contributing visibly and substantially to the fulfillment of our area business's strategies.

The Academy provides a rewarding work environment and fair compensation to our employees; ultimately provide excellent value to our customers and a fair return to our owners.

vision is bridging the digital gab between the rural and urban areas.

- **Objectives**

The Ruralnet Training College knows firsthand that computer training has to meet all of its customers' needs in order to have a tangible lasting impact. When you measure across multiple customer segments—each of which has its own priorities—you see how much more training must do to consistently and simultaneously satisfy participants, managers, and executives. Training then can move to close those gaps and deliver more real values. Closing those gaps between employer skill needs, employee and learner skills development is the main objective of our institution.

Policy objectives

Guidance

Administrative policy provides clear direction to both **administrators and staff** on how to perform their duties effectively. This includes guidelines on teaching procedures, managing computer labs, handling student data, and maintaining professional conduct.

Uniformity

It ensures **consistency in operations and decision-making** across the entire institution. Uniformity means that all departments — such as networking, programming, and database management — follow the same administrative rules for attendance, grading, communication,

and use of ICT resources.

Accountability

Administrative policies make individuals and departments **answerable for their actions and performance**. This ensures that Instructors, Accountants, and administrators perform their duties responsibly — such as maintaining ICT resources, marking assignments on time, and using college funds properly.

Control

Policies help **maintain discipline and order** by setting clear rules and boundaries. This involves regulating the use of computers, internet access, and software licenses, as well as enforcing codes of conduct for both staff and students.

Efficiency

Administrative policies aim to **simplify processes and improve productivity**.
Efficiency can mean smoother operations — like automated student registration, digital record keeping, or organized scheduling of labs and classes.

Legal and regulatory framework

The Computer Society of Kenya

Ruralnet ICT registered with Computer Society of Kenya (CSK) in 2017 and was granted full accreditation for offering ICT Courses, ranging from basic courses to advanced ones.

CSK certificate/membership number is 007569

Cisco Networking Academy

Certified Cisco Networking Academy ID: 48943725

Kenya Accountants and Secretaries National Examinations Board (KASNEB)

On 2nd October 2025, KASNEB board sent an investigative team to conduct assessment and institutional evaluation. The exercise took place and the collected information were presented to the KASNEB board for approval.

Ruralnet Training College is currently waiting for approval and interim accreditation by the KASNEB board.

Technical and Vocational Education and Training Authority

Ruralnet Training College is preparing to host TVETA official for college evaluation and assessment anytime once the required documentations are ready.

Scope and applicability

This policy manual is and shall always be applicable by any person attached temporarily and permanently at Ruralnet Training College.

The policy contains instructions and procedures of activities academically and professionally for both students/clients and employee/staff.

CHAPTER TWO

GOVERNANCE AND INSTITUTIONAL STRUCTURE

Governance

Ruralnet Training College is organized into a hierarchy with top, middle and operational management levels. The company has various departments which assist in the delivery of quality services to the clients.

- **Top Management**
  - This level of management consists of an organization's chief executive or managing director. It is the ultimate source of power and authority, since it oversees the goals, policies, and procedures of the company. Some roles and responsibilities of the top management can be summarized as follows:
  - Laying down the objectives and broad policies of the business enterprise.
  - Issuing necessary instructions for the preparation of department-specific programs, schedules, procedures, etc.
  - Preparing strategic plans and policies for the organization.
  - Appointing the employees for middle-level management, i.e. departmental managers.

Establishing controls of all organizational departments. Strategic planning and execution of the overall business success.

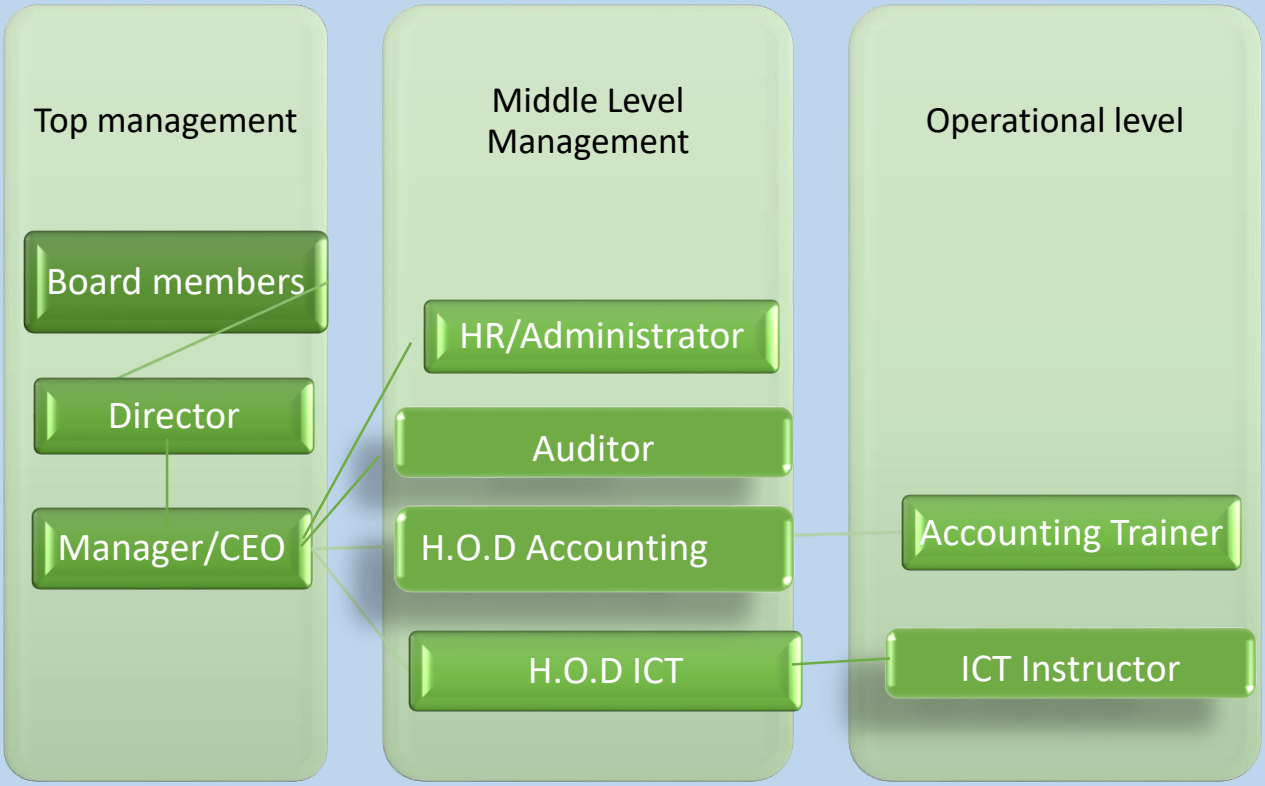
- **Middle Level of Management**
  1. The Departmental managers form this middle management level. These people are directly accountable to top management for the functioning of their respective departments, devoting more time to organizational and directional functions. Some of their roles are; Executing the plans of the organization in accordance with the policies and directives laid out by the top management level.
  - Forming plans for the sub-units of the organization that they supervise
  - Participating in the hiring and training processes of lower-level management.

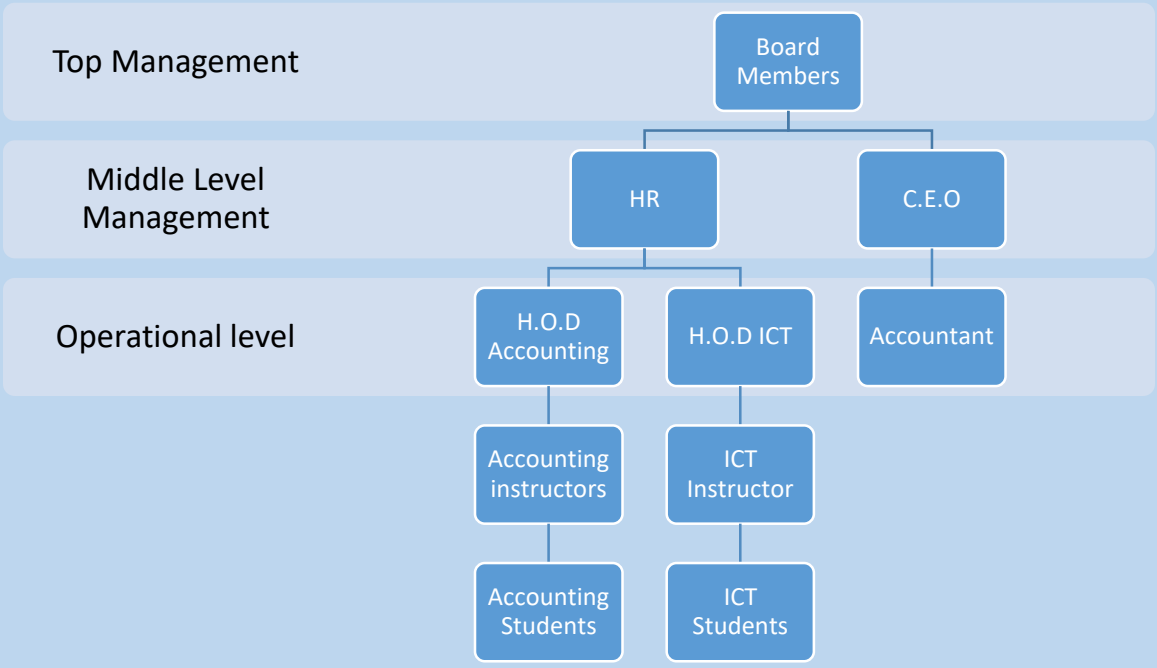
- Interpreting and explaining the policies from top-level management to lower-level management.
- Sending reports and data to top management in a timely and efficient manner.

○ **Operational Level of Management**

This level consists of operational employees whose job is to complete tasks assigned by the manager. They include ICT instructors, Technicians and marketing personnel.

Organizational structure





- **Duties and responsibilities**

1. **Board Member**

Duties/Responsibilities:

- Ensuring all assets are used prudently.
- Ensuring all decisions are made in the best interests of the organization and help it move closer to its mission.
- Ensuring the organization abides by all laws and regulations, as well as its own By-laws.
- Strategic governance and oversight.
- Serving the organization's stakeholders.
- Managing budgets.
- Setting policies.
- Overseeing personnel.
- Setting goals.
- Measuring goals and achievements.

2. **Director/Conducts performance evaluations that are timely and constructive**

- Reviews existing training programs; suggests enhancements and modifications to improve engagement, learning, and retention and/or to meet the changing needs of clientele, the organization, or the industry
- Ensures that training materials and programs are current, accurate, and effective. Maintains

knowledge of new methods and techniques for training, and training requirements applicable to the organization and/or industry

- Identifies problems and opportunities such as operational changes or industry developments that training could improve.
- Conducts or facilitates required and recommended training sessions.
- Collaborates with vendors and third-party training providers to arrange employee registration for and participation in outside training programs.
- Ensures that training milestones and goals are met while adhering to approved training budget.
- Prepares and implements training budget.
- Performs other related duties as assigned.

1. ICT instructors/IT consultant/ICT technician

- Design, facilitate and teach the computer instruction component
- Assess, supervise, and motivate students
- Evaluating student work and progress
- Prepare and execute lesson plans
- Develop course syllabus
- Assigning tasks
- Install, configure, and maintain computer hardware, software, and peripheral devices.
- Set up and manage local and wide area networks (LAN/WAN)
- Monitor and troubleshoot hardware, software, and network issues.
- Perform regular system updates, backups, and data recovery operations.
- Configure and secure routers, switches, firewalls, and Wi-Fi access points.
- Provide technical support and user assistance for ICT systems.
- Manage and administer servers, email systems, and user accounts.
- Implement cybersecurity measures to protect data and systems.
- Conduct ICT audits and recommend system improvements.
- Develop and enforce ICT policies, standards, and procedures.
- Maintain records of ICT assets, licenses, and configurations.
- Manage institutional websites, online portals, and databases.
- Offer advice on ICT solutions, procurement, and system upgrades.
- Conduct staff or client training on ICT tools and best practices.
- Participate in ICT project planning, budgeting, and implementation.
- Research and recommend emerging technologies to improve efficiency.
- Ensure compliance with data protection and ICT security regulations.
- Maintain and service ICT infrastructure (servers, UPS, cabling, etc.).
- Liaise with vendors and service providers for ICT-related contracts.
- Prepare periodic ICT performance reports and documentation

Core Competencies

- Creative and innovative.
- Strong problem-solving and analytical skills.

- Excellent communication and teamwork.
- Attention to detail and documentation accuracy.
- High integrity, professionalism, and confidentiality.

Professional qualifications

- Degree/Diploma/Certificate holder in ICT/Computer science/ICT technician, software engineering
- Academic credentials from recognized institution and official exam bodies such as KASNEB, KNEC, CDACC, CSK

3. Administrator/HR

- Manage budgets, logistics and events or meetings
- Handle scheduling, record-keeping and reporting
- Ensure the school complies with relevant laws and regulations
- Develop and run educational programs
- Hire, train and advise staff
- Counsel students when needed
- Resolve conflicts and other issues
- Communicate with parents, regulatory bodies and the public
- Have a hand in the creation of the school curriculum
- Implement actions that improve the school and the quality of education (e.g. building renovations, new guidelines for students, new subjects)

Check for any information in the institution's communication channels such as messages and managing incoming/outgoing messages. Help shape and uphold the vision of the school

Professional qualifications

- Degree/Diploma/Certificate in HR/Secretarial/Business administration/Business management/Public Relations/Customer Service & front office/Records & Information Management/Computerized office applications/Supervisory management & Leadership/Human Resource Information Systems (HRIS)/Project Management

Core Competencies

- Ability to communicate clearly, professionally, and effectively.
- Strong ability to plan, prioritize, and manage multiple tasks efficiently.
- Handling sensitive information discreetly and maintaining ethical standards.

- Accuracy in data entry, documentation, and correspondence.
- Professional and courteous interaction with clients, employees, and stakeholders.
- Meeting deadlines, managing schedules, and maintaining productivity.
- Working effectively with colleagues across departments.
- Ability to identify, analyze, and resolve issues efficiently.
- Skilled in Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook) and office equipment use.
- Demonstrating reliability, accountability, and a positive attitude.

4. Accounting trainer

- Develop, review, and update course syllabi to meet KASNEB and institutional requirements.
- Align course content with current accounting standards (IFRS, IAS, IPSAS, GAAP).
- Prepare lesson plans, schemes of work, and teaching materials (slides, notes, case studies).
- Integrate practical examples, simulations, and case studies in lessons to enhance understanding.
- Conduct interactive lectures, tutorials, and workshops for students pursuing **CAM, ATD, CPA, FCPA, or CIFA**.
- Teach **financial accounting, management accounting, taxation, auditing, financial management, and business law**, among others.
- Use modern teaching tools (e.g., Excel, QuickBooks, Sage, Tally, or Power BI) for applied learning.
- Incorporate **data analysis techniques** (Excel, SPSS, Python, or Power BI) where relevant to financial analytics.
- Offer extra remedial sessions to weak students or exam re-sitters.
- Prepare, administer, and mark class tests, assignments, term papers, and mock exams.
- Evaluate student performance, track progress, and provide constructive feedback.
- Design practical tasks or mini-projects that test both theory and practical competence.
- Prepare students for **professional exams (KASNEB)** and monitor exam pass rates.\
- Provide academic and career guidance to learners in accounting and finance fields.
- Mentor students on professional ethics, workplace conduct, and continuous professional development.
- Advise students on exam registration, progression paths, and specialization (e.g., audit, tax, financial management).
- Encourage use of online learning resources and professional networks.
- Maintain accurate records of student attendance, performance, and exam results.
- Submit periodic teaching reports and exam analyses to management.
- Participate in departmental meetings, academic boards, and curriculum review committees.
- Assist in planning and coordinating training timetables or examination schedules.
- Stay updated with changes in accounting standards, taxation laws, and financial regulations.

- Attend workshops, seminars, and CPD programs organized by KASNEB or other professional bodies.
- Participate in institutional research, publications, and consultancy activities.
- Support marketing and outreach programs to promote accounting and data courses.
- Train students on **data-driven decision-making** using Excel, SQL, Python, or Power BI.
- Demonstrate use of accounting software (QuickBooks, Sage, Tally, or Zoho Books).
- Integrate ICT and e-learning tools (Google Classroom, Zoom, MS Teams, or Moodle).
- Evaluate and implement digital teaching aids for improved student engagement.
- Promote integrity, confidentiality, and ethical behavior in teaching and assessment.
- Model professional standards consistent with accounting body codes of conduct
- Uphold fairness and transparency in student evaluation and communication.

Core Competencies

- Strong knowledge of accounting and finance principles.
- Excellent presentation, communication, and mentoring skills.
- Competency in accounting software and analytical tools.
- Ability to link theory with real-world business applications.
- Familiarity with **KASNEB curriculum** and exam structure.

Qualifications

Academic Qualifications

1. **Diploma or Bachelor's Degree** in any of the following fields (or equivalent):
    - Accounting
    - Finance
    - Commerce (BCom)
    - Business Administration (Accounting/Finance option)
    - Economics
    - Data Analytics / Statistics (for data-related modules)

Professional Qualifications

The trainer should possess **at least one** of the following recognized professional certifications:

Level	Professional Qualification	Requirement
Certificate & Diploma Trainers (CAM / ATD)	- CPA Section 4 and above - ATD Finalist - Diploma in Accounting or Finance (KNEC or equivalent)	Must have sufficient practical knowledge in bookkeeping, costing, and financial systems.

Professional Course Trainers (CPA / FCPA / CIFA)	- Certified Public Accountant (CPA-K) – Fully qualified - Certified Investment and Financial Analyst (CIFA-K) - Fellow Certified Public Accountant (FCPA) – for advanced or senior-level training	Registration with a professional body (e.g., ICPAK) is essential.
Data Analysis Trainers (Finance-oriented)	- Certification in **Data Analysis / Data Analytics / Business Intelligence** tools (e.g., Excel, Power BI, Python, SPSS, R). - Additional qualifications like **Certified Data Analyst (CDA)** or **Microsoft Data Analyst Associate** are added advantages.	Should be able to integrate analytics with accounting data.

Technical and ICT Skills

- Proficiency in **MS Office Suite** (Excel, PowerPoint, Word).
- Hands-on experience in **accounting software** (QuickBooks, Tally, Sage, or ERP systems).
- Familiarity with **data tools** like Power BI, SPSS, R, or Python (for analytics courses).
- Knowledge of **online teaching tools** (Zoom, Google Classroom, MS Teams, Moodle).

Soft Skills and Competencies

- Excellent **communication** and **presentation** skills.
- Strong **analytical** and **problem-solving** ability.
- Passion for teaching, mentorship, and continuous learning.
- High ethical standards and integrity.
- Ability to simplify complex accounting and finance concepts.
- Commitment to student success and professional development.

CHAPTER THREE

HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT/

Recruitment and appointment procedures

This section ensures transparency, fairness, and merit-based selection when hiring academic, technical, and administrative staff.

Objectives;

- Transparency and fairness,
- Based on merit and qualifications,
- Alignment with the institution's goals, policies, and legal framework.

Scope

- Applies to all categories of employees in the at Ruralnet Training College:

Guiding Principles

- Recruitment must adhere to the following principles:
- No discrimination based on gender, age, religion, ethnicity, or disability, race or color.
- Candidates must meet the required qualifications and competencies.
- The process should be open and competitive.
- All decisions must be documented and justifiable.
- Must follow labour laws, institutional guidelines and regulations.

Recruitment Process

a. Staffing Needs Identification

- Department heads identify vacant positions or new staffing requirements.
- A justification memo is submitted to the Administrator/HR.
- The request specifies:
    - Job title and description,
    - Qualifications required,
    - Reason for recruitment (replacement/new post),
    - Duration (permanent, contract, part-time).

b. Approval to recruit

- The Manger/CEO reviews and discuses the request.
- Once approved, HR prepares a **Recruitment Plan** (timeline, budget, selection panel).

c. Job advertisement

- Vacancies are advertised publicly through, website, social media or Linkedin job portal.
- Each advert includes:
  - Job title, duties, and responsibilities,
  - Minimum qualifications and experience,
  - Application procedure and deadline,
  - Equal opportunity statement.

d. Receipt and Shortlisting of Applications

- HR receives all applications and compiles a list.
- The **Administrator and Manager** shortlists candidates based on advertised qualifications.
- A **shortlisting report** is prepared and signed by the CEO

e. Shortlisting and interviews

- Shortlisted candidates are invited for interviews.
- Selection methods may include:
  - Oral interviews,
  - Practical/technical tests (for ICT and technical positions),
  - Teaching demonstrations (for lecturers),
  - Aptitude or written tests (for administrative posts).
- Each candidate is scored using a standard evaluation form.
- CEO recommends the most suitable candidate(s).

f. Approval and Appointment

- Interview results are submitted to the CEO for approval.
- Successful candidates receive **formal appointment letters**, stating:
  - Position title,
  - Terms of service (permanent, contract, probationary),
  - Salary and benefits,
  - Reporting date.
- Unsuccessful candidates are notified respectfully.

g. Orientation and Induction

- New staff undergo an induction program covering:

- Institutional mission, vision, and policies,
- Job expectations and performance evaluation,
- Code of conduct and ethics,
- Health, safety, and ICT systems orientation.

Probation and Confirmation

- New employees serve a **probation period** of 1 month
- During probation:
    - Supervisors/CEO evaluate performance and conduct.
    - HR conducts progress reviews.
- Upon satisfactory performance, the staff member is **confirmed** in employment through a written confirmation letter.

Records and Documentation

- HR/Administrator maintains a file for each employee containing:
    - Application materials,
    - Interview records,
    - Appointment letters,
    - Performance appraisals,
    - Contract renewals or termination records.

Recruitment of Part-Time and Accounting trainers

- Part-time lecturers may be engaged when:
    - Accounting courses' students are enrolled,
    - The Institution requires a trainer in Video editing and auditions,
    - There is an increased teaching workload.
- They are appointed on **fixed-term contracts** specifying teaching hours, subjects, and remuneration.
- Must meet the same minimum qualifications as full-time lecturers.

Promotion and Internal Recruitment

- Internal candidates may be considered for higher positions based on:
    - Experience, performance, and qualifications.
    - Vacancy availability and recommendation from the supervisor.
- Promotion follows a similar transparent process as external recruitment.

Review of Recruitment Policy

The recruitment and appointment policy should be reviewed every **3 years** or whenever legal or institutional changes occur.

Staff Code of Conduct and Ethics for Ruralnet Training College

Objective

To promote ethical behavior, professionalism, and integrity among all staff members of the ICT College, ensuring that the institution maintains high moral and professional standards in delivering education and services.

Guiding Ethical Principles

All staff are expected to demonstrate:

1. **Integrity:** Honesty and consistency in actions and decisions.
2. **Accountability:** Taking responsibility for one's actions and performance.
3. **Professionalism:** Maintaining competence, courtesy, and respect in all duties.
4. **Confidentiality:** Protecting institutional and personal information.
5. **Respect:** Upholding dignity and diversity among students and colleagues.
6. **Impartiality:** Avoiding favoritism, discrimination, or bias.
7. **Commitment:** Dedication to Ruralnet's mission and continuous improvement.

General Conduct Expectations

All staff must:

- Observe **official working hours** and perform assigned duties diligently.
- Dress **appropriately and decently** while on duty.
- Maintain **discipline, punctuality, and reliability.**

- Avoid **negligence, absenteeism, or lateness** without valid reason.
- Foster teamwork and a positive institutional image.
- Adhere to **institutional rules, national laws, and TVET guidelines.**
- Staff are expected to report to work and classes **on time**.
- Absence must be communicated in advance and supported by valid reasons.
- Repeated absenteeism or lateness may lead to **disciplinary action**.
- Use institutional funds and resources responsibly.
- Record and report all financial transactions accurately.
- Avoid misuse of assets or embezzlement.
- Follow approved procurement and financial procedures.

Professional Ethics for Academic Staff/Trainers

Teaching staff shall:

- Prepare adequately and deliver lessons effectively.
- Use teaching aids, ICT/Accounting tools, and methods that enhance learning.
- Treat students fairly, equally, and respectfully.
- Refrain from any form of **harassment**, **favoritism**, or **discrimination**.
- Maintain **academic integrity** — no falsification of grades or records.
- Protect **student confidentiality** (personal and academic information).
- Avoid plagiarism and promote honesty in research and assignments.
- Mentor students and encourage innovation and ethical ICT practice.
- Maintain **professional relationships** with students and colleagues.
- Avoid any form of **sexual harassment, intimidation, or exploitation**.
- Promote mutual respect, cooperation, and inclusivity.
- Avoid gossip, defamation, or spreading false information.

Use of ICT Facilities and Resources

Staff must:

- Use ICT facilities (computers, internet, email, systems) **for official and academic purposes only**.
- Avoid misuse such as:
    - Unauthorized data access or alteration,
    - Downloading or sharing illegal or obscene content,
    - Installing unlicensed software.
- Protect college data and systems from viruses and cyber threats.
- Keep login credentials and passwords confidential.

- Report ICT security breaches immediately.

7. Conflict of Interest

Staff must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with college duties.
Examples include:

- Favoring relatives or friends in hiring, grading, or procurement.
- Using institutional resources for personal gain.
- Accepting gifts, bribes, or favors that could influence decisions.

All potential conflicts must be declared in writing to the CEO through Admin/HR Office.

Confidentiality and Data Protection

- Staff must not disclose confidential information about:
    - Students, staff, or institutional matters.
    - Financial, academic, or administrative records.
- Confidential data may only be shared with **authorized persons** for official purposes.
- All staff must comply with the **Data Protection Act** and institutional ICT policies.

Prohibited Behaviors

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Corruption, bribery, or fraud.
- Discrimination or harassment (sexual, verbal, physical).
- Drunkenness or substance abuse while on duty.
- Unauthorized use of college property.
- Falsification of records or documents.
- Unauthorized absence from duty.
- Leaking examination materials or confidential data.

Disciplinary Actions

Every staff member must **read, understand, and sign** a **Code of Conduct Declaration Form** upon appointment. Signing indicates agreement to comply with all institutional policies and ethical standards.

Violation of this Code shall result in disciplinary measures, which may include:

- Written warning,
- Suspension,
- Demotion,
- Dismissal

All disciplinary actions will follow due process.

Reporting Misconduct

- Staff are expected to report any issue to the Administrator/HR who will provide appropriate advice. If the issue is beyond her office to handle, she shall forward the matter to the Manager/CEO
- All students must report their grievances/issues to their immediate trainer.
- Incase the issue involves trainer and a student, Administrator may cheap in to offer solution. Student still allowed to report to HR in this matter.
- Issues regarding lending and borrowing between students, staff and student-staff shall not be handle in the institution's office.
- Any deal between student/client and staff done outside the institution shall not be handled at the office and the parties involved will be answerable.

Performance Appraisal and Promotions

Purpose

To ensure staff performance is regularly assessed, improved, and recognized, and that promotions are based on merit, competence, and institutional needs.

Objectives

- To evaluate employee performance against set targets.
- To identify strengths, weaknesses, and training needs.
- To provide a fair basis for rewards, promotions, and disciplinary action.
- To enhance accountability and productivity.

Appraisal System

- Conducted **annually**).

- Managed by the **Human Resource Department** in collaboration with Heads of Departments (HODs).
- Based on measurable indicators such as:

    - Teaching effectiveness.
    - Job output and quality.
    - Punctuality and attendance.
    - Innovation and ICT integration.
    - Teamwork and communication.
    - Adherence to institutional policies and ethics.

Appraisal Tools

- Standardized **Performance Appraisal Form** (rating scale 1–5).
- Self-assessment, supervisor evaluation, and peer review.
- Lesson observation, student feedback, exam results, and research contribution.
- Task completion, reliability, and service delivery.

Promotion Policy

Promotions are granted based on:

- Proven competence and sustained high performance.
- Required academic/professional qualifications.
- Relevant work experience.
- Availability of a vacancy or budgetary provision.
- Recommendation by the supervisor and HR.

All promotions must be approved by the **CEO/Manager**.

Documentation

Each staff member's appraisal report is filed in their personal record for reference in promotions, transfers, or training decisions.

Training and Professional Development

This is done to enhance staff skills, knowledge, and competence to meet evolving educational and technological demands.

Objectives

- To promote continuous learning and capacity building.
- To align staff skills with institutional objectives.

- To encourage adoption of emerging ICT tools and practices.
- To enhance teaching, management, and service quality.

Types of Training

- **Induction Training:** For newly recruited staff to understand institutional policies.
- **On-the-job Training:** Hands-on training in daily tasks or new systems.
- **Workshops and Seminars:** For new technologies, pedagogy, or ICT trends.
- **Formal Courses:** TVET, KNEC, or university courses for qualification upgrading.
- **E-learning:** Online short courses in ICT and management.

Sponsorship and Support

- The college may sponsor or co-fund staff attending relevant training.
- Sponsored staff must sign a **bond** to serve the college for a specified period after training.
- Staff may also pursue self-sponsored studies with prior approval to avoid disruption of duties.
- Ruralnet ICT also has plan to support students who are willing to study computer courses, but lack funds.
- Those who are willing to conduct front office training for employment purposes are also trained free provided they are alumni.

Evaluation

- HR evaluates the effectiveness of training programs through post-training reports and improved performance indicators.

Leave Policy, Remuneration, and Welfare

The main aim for this is to provide fair and consistent guidelines on leave entitlement, compensation, and staff welfare, in line with the **Kenya Employment Act** and institutional policies.

Leave Policy

Types of Leave:

1. **Sick Leave:**
    - Granted upon signs of unwell or unstable health.
    - Full pay for up to 30 days; half pay thereafter, subject to review.
2. **Maternity Leave:**
    - Female staff: 90 calendar days with full pay.
    - No loss of seniority or benefits.
3. **Paternity Leave:**

- Male staff: 14 calendar days with full pay.

4. **Compassionate Leave:**
   - Up to 5 days for emergencies (death or illness of immediate family).
5. **Study Leave:**
   - Granted to staff pursuing approved studies, subject to service bond.
6. **Annual/Monthly leave:**
   - Should be granted monthly or yearly.

Remuneration Policy

- Salary scales are determined by:
  - Qualifications, job grade, and experience.
  - Institutional financial capability.
- Salaries are paid **monthly**.
- Regular **salary reviews** may occur every year or based on economic conditions.
- Additional allowances may include:
  - Responsibility allowance,
  - Transport allowance,
  - Extra service allowance
  - Congratulatory allowance

Staff Welfare

The college promotes staff well-being through:

- Health and safety programs.
- Hospital billing.
- Staff social welfare (for bereavement, weddings, etc.).
- Recreational and team-building activities.
- Counseling and mentorship services.
- Fair grievance and complaint handling procedures.

Disciplinary Procedures

Disciplinary procedures helps maintain discipline, fairness, and order among all staff members while ensuring due process is observed.

Objectives

- To correct misconduct rather than punish.
- To protect the rights of both the institution and the employee.
- To uphold the integrity and reputation of the college.

Forms of Misconduct

- Absenteeism or habitual lateness.
- Insubordination or refusal to obey lawful orders.
- Negligence of duty.
- Misuse of institution's property.
- Theft, fraud, or corruption.
- Harassment or discrimination.
- Breach of confidentiality.
- Drunkenness or drug abuse during working hours.
- Academic malpractice

Disciplinary Procedure Steps

1. **Verbal Warning:**
    - For minor offenses; recorded in the employee's file.
2. **Written Warning:**
    - Issued if misconduct persists or is moderate.
3. **Show Cause Letter:**
    - Employee is asked to explain within a given timeframe.
4. **Disciplinary Hearing:**
    - Conducted by the **Disciplinary Committee** (HR, HOD, and CEO).
    - The employee may present witnesses or evidence.
5. **Decision:**
    - The committee recommends action:
        - Written warning,
        - Suspension,
        - Demotion,
        - Termination, or
        - Dismissal (for gross misconduct).
6. **Appeal:**
    - The employee may appeal to the CEO within 14 days of decision.

Disciplinary Records

All proceedings, warnings, and decisions must be documented and kept in the employee's confidential file.

Code Reference

All disciplinary actions shall align with:

- Kenya Employment Act (2007, Revised 2021),
- Public Service Commission guidelines, and
- Institutional HR policy.

CHAPTER FOUR

ACADEMIC ADMINISTRATION POLICY

The **Academic Administration Policy** governs how all teaching, learning, and academic activities are conducted at Ruralnet Training College. It ensures that the institution maintains **high academic standards, quality assurance, and compliance** with national education and training authorities.

Curriculum Design and Approval

This section outlines how an ICT college develops, reviews, and approves its academic programs to ensure **quality, relevance, and compliance** with national and international educational standards.

Purpose

The goal of curriculum design and approval is to ensure that all ICT-related courses offered by the college:

- Meet the **requirements of accrediting and regulatory bodies** such as **TVET-CDACC**, **KNEC**, or universities.
- Address **industry needs** and emerging technological trends.
- Equip students with **competent skills**, **knowledge**, and **professional ethics** relevant to ICT practice.

Curriculum Development Process

The process involves several key stages:

1. **Needs Assessment:**

    - Conducted to identify skill gaps in the ICT sector and align courses with labor market demands.
    - Involves consultation with employers, alumni, and professional bodies.

2. **Curriculum Design:**
    - Curriculum developers (Trainers) prepare the structure, learning outcomes, course content, and assessment methods.
    - Integrates both **theoretical and practical components** (e.g., coding, networking simulations, ICT resources).
    - Emphasizes **competency-based education and training (CBET)** principles, especially for TVET/CDACC programs.
3. **Internal Review:**
    - The draft curriculum is reviewed by the **Academic Board** or **Curriculum Committee** for quality assurance.
    - Recommendations for improvement are made before submission for external evaluation.
4. **Implementation:**
    - Once approved, the curriculum is rolled out, and teaching resources (equipment, labs, materials) are prepared.
    - Lecturers are oriented on delivery and assessment methods.
5. **Periodic Review:**
    - Conducted every 3–5 years or as directed by the regulatory body.
    - Internal reviews are done monthly to ensure the curriculum remains **up-to-date** with technological advancements such as AI, cloud computing, data analytics, and IoT.

Teaching and Learning Methods (ICT Integration, Blended Learning)

This section outlines the approaches and strategies used by Ruralnet ICT to **deliver knowledge and skills effectively**. It emphasizes the use of **modern technology**, **interactive pedagogy**, and **student-centered methods** to enhance learning outcomes.

The goal is to ensure that teaching and learning processes:

- Produce **competent ICT and accounting professionals** capable of applying knowledge in real-world contexts.
- Incorporate **information and communication technology (ICT)** tools to make learning more engaging, flexible, and efficient.

- Encourage **innovation, collaboration, and continuous improvement** in both teaching practice and student learning.

ICT Integration in Teaching and Learning

ICT is embedded in all aspects of instruction to reflect the digital nature of the field. Key strategies include:

1. **Use of Digital Learning Platforms**

    - Learning Management Systems (LMS) such as **Google Classroom, Moodle, or Microsoft Teams** are used to share notes, assignments, and feedback.
    - Enables **online submission, grading, and performance tracking**.

2. **Interactive Multimedia Tools**

    - Incorporates **videos, animations, virtual labs, simulations**, and **coding environments** (e.g., Visual Studio Code, Cisco Packet Tracer) to demonstrate concepts practically.
    - Enhances understanding through visual and hands-on experiences.

3. **E-Libraries and Online Resources**

    - Students access e-books, journals, and open educational resources for research and self-directed learning.
    - Encourages **independent study** and critical thinking.

4. **Virtual Collaboration Tools**

    - Platforms like **Zoom, Google Meet, and Slack** are used for virtual lectures, discussions, and group projects.
    - Promotes communication beyond the classroom.

5. **Digital Assessment and Feedback**

    - Online quizzes, coding tests, and digital project submissions help evaluate student understanding efficiently.
    - Automated grading and instant feedback enhance learning outcomes.

Blended Learning Approach

Blended learning combines **face-to-face instruction** with **online education** to create a flexible, technology-enhanced learning environment.

1. **Face-to-Face Component**

    - Conducted in classrooms, computer labs, or workshops.
    - Focuses on demonstrations, hands-on practice, and real-time feedback.
    - Encourages interaction between trainers and learners.

2. **Online Component**

    - Delivered through e-learning platforms, recorded lectures, discussion forums, and virtual labs.
    - Allows learners to study at their own pace and revisit materials.

3. **Advantages of Blended Learning**

    - Promotes **flexibility** and accessibility.
    - Encourages **self-regulated learning** and digital literacy.
    - Supports **continuous learning** even beyond the physical classroom.
    - Enables **data tracking** for academic performance improvement.

Student-Centered Learning Approaches

Student-centered learning (SCL) is an instructional approach that shifts the focus of education from the teacher to the student. It emphasizes **active participation**, **collaboration**, **critical thinking**, and **practical application** of knowledge — especially vital in ICT education where skills development and innovation are key.

The main goal of student-centered learning at Ruralnet Training College is to:

- Develop **independent and critical thinkers** capable of solving real-world ICT problems.
- Encourage **active learning** through projects, labs, and collaborative work.
- Foster **creativity, innovation, and lifelong learning**.
- Align teaching with the **competency-based education (CBE)** model required by **TVET/CDACC, KNEC, and universities**.

Key Principles of Student-Centered Learning

1. **Active Learning:**
   Students are directly engaged through coding, simulations, experiments, and interactive discussions rather than passive note-taking.
2. **Learner Autonomy:**
   Students take responsibility for their own learning through self-directed projects, research, and peer collaboration.
3. **Competency-Based Education:**
   Emphasis is placed on mastery of specific ICT skills and competencies rather than just completion of coursework.
4. **Collaborative Learning:**
   Learners work in groups on tasks such as network configuration, database development, or web projects — simulating real workplace teamwork.
5. **Problem-Based Learning (PBL):**
   Students solve authentic ICT challenges (e.g., troubleshooting network issues, designing applications, debugging programs, fixing software related issues emanating from Microsoft applications) that require creativity and analytical thinking.
6. **Experiential and Project-Based Learning:**
   Learning is reinforced through **hands-on practice**, **attachments**, **hackathons**, and **capstone projects**.
7. **Continuous Feedback and Reflection:**
   Trainers provide regular, formative feedback;

   Students reflect on their learning process to identify strengths and improvement areas.

8. **ICT Integration:**
   Use of e-learning platforms, simulations, coding environments, and multimedia tools to enhance learning and digital literacy.

Teaching Strategies for Student-Centered Learning at Ruralnet Training College

Method	Description	Example
Flipped Classroom	Students review theory or tutorials online, and class time is used for practice or discussion.	Going through HTML templates from ruralnet.co.ke before class, then coding a webpage during class.
Project-Based Learning (PBL)	Students work on long-term projects that integrate multiple skills.	Developing a school management system or mobile app as a group project.
Collaborative Learning	Peer-to-peer interaction to solve problems or discuss topics.	Group troubleshooting of network configurations.
Case Studies and Simulations	Real-world scenarios to apply ICT knowledge.	Simulating cybersecurity attacks and defense strategies.
Peer Teaching	Students explain or present topics to others.	A student demonstrates database normalization techniques to classmates.
Inquiry-Based Learning	Students research and investigate answers to open-ended questions.	"How can cloud computing improve business data storage?"

E-Learning and Blended Learning	Combines online materials with face-to-face interaction.	Using Moodle or Google Classroom for assignments and quizzes.

Role of Students

Students are expected to:

- Take **initiative** in their learning process.
- Participate actively in discussions, labs, and projects.
- Collaborate respectfully with peers.
- Demonstrate **critical thinking** and **problem-solving** in ICT tasks.
- Apply **ethical and responsible use of technology** in all coursework.

Assessment in Student-Centered Learning

- Assessments focus on **skills demonstration** and **practical application**, not memorization.
- Includes **continuous assessment**, **project evaluation**, **peer assessment**, and **self-assessment**.
- Rubrics are provided to ensure transparency and fairness.
- Formative feedback guides improvement before final evaluations.

Benefits of Student-Centered Learning in ICT

- Enhances **technical competence** and **employability**.
- Promotes **collaboration**, **communication**, and **leadership skills**.
- Encourages **innovation** and adaptability to emerging technologies.
- Improves **student motivation and retention** through engagement.
- Builds a **lifelong learning mindset**, essential in the dynamic ICT industry.

Institutional Support for Student-Centered Learning

To effectively implement SCL, Ruralnet ICT must:

- Provide **modern labs, internet access, and e-learning platforms**.
- Train staff in **active learning methodologies and ICT integration**.
- Develop **policies** encouraging innovation, research, and student participation.
- Recognize and reward excellence in teaching and student innovation.

Examination Administration and Grading System

This section provides guidelines for the **planning, conducting, and evaluating of student assessments**. It ensures that examinations and grading are **fair, transparent, reliable, and aligned** with the standards set by regulatory bodies such as **TVET-CDACC**, **KNEC**, or universities.

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Maintain **academic integrity** and **quality assurance** in assessment processes.
- Ensure that student evaluations reflect **competence**, **knowledge**, and **practical skills** gained.
- Provide clear and consistent criteria for measuring academic performance.
- Comply with national and institutional examination regulations.

Examination Administration Procedures

Examination administration covers the entire process from setting to release of results.

a. Examination Planning

- The **Academic Board or Examinations Committee/HOD** prepares the academic calendar and examination timetable.
- Trainers submit exam questions early for moderation and approval.
- Students are informed of exam schedules and rules in advance.

b. Setting and Moderation of Examinations

- Examinations are designed to assess both **theoretical knowledge** and **practical ICT skills**.
- Question papers and marking schemes are **moderated internally** and, where applicable, **externally**.
- This ensures that exams meet **standard learning outcomes** and **curriculum objectives**.

c. Examination Conduct

- Exams are conducted under strict **supervision and invigilation** to prevent malpractice.
- Students must present valid identification and adhere to examination rules.
- Electronic devices, unauthorized notes, and plagiarism are prohibited.
- Examination irregularities lead to **disciplinary action** as per institutional policy.

d. Marking and Verification

- Scripts are marked promptly by course trainers using approved marking guides.
- Marks are verified by the **Head of Department (HOD)** and the **Examination Officer** to ensure consistency and accuracy.

e. Results Approval and Release

- Results are presented to the **Academic Board** for approval before publication.
- Students can access results through announcement page in our website, student portals, or printed transcripts.
- Confidentiality and data protection are maintained at all stages.

Grading System

Grading systems generally follows standardized score ranges:

Marks Range (%)	Grade	Description	Remarks
80 – 100	A. Mastery	Excellent	Distinction
70 – 79	Mastery	Very Good	Credit
60 – 69	Proficiency	Good	Credit
50 – 59	Competent	Fair	Pass
Below 50	Not Competent	Poor/Fail	Fail

- **Continuous Assessments (CATs):** 100%
  (This may vary slightly depending on the decision of the trainer.)

Supplementary and Special Examinations

- Students who fail a paper may be allowed to **sit a supplementary exam**, and he/she is expected to pay a re-sit fee of Kshs. 500
- **Special exams** are provided for students who miss exams due to valid reasons (illness, bereavement, official duty), upon approval.
- Re-sit marks are usually **capped at the pass grade**.

Examination Security and Confidentiality

- Examination materials are **secured** in locked storage before use.
- Printing, transport, and distribution are handled by **authorized personnel only**.
- Examination data and results are stored securely and backed up electronically.
- Any leakage, alteration, or unauthorized access constitutes a serious disciplinary offense.

External Examinations

- For programs under **KASNEB, TVET-CDACC** or **KNEC**, the institution follows their rules for registration, administration, and grading.
- The institution acts as an **approved examination center** and collaborates with external moderators and assessors.

Continuous Improvement

- Ruralnet periodically reviews her examination and grading systems to maintain **fairness, accuracy, and relevance**.
- Feedback from students, trainers, and examiners is used to enhance assessment quality.

Student Assessment and Moderation

This section outlines how students' academic performance is **evaluated, verified, and standardized** to ensure fairness, consistency, and alignment with national and institutional standards. It focuses on **how assessments are conducted and moderated** to maintain the integrity and quality of education in ICT programs.

The purpose of student assessment and moderation is to:

- Evaluate **student learning outcomes** and competencies effectively.
- Ensure **consistency and fairness** across different courses, trainers, and assessment methods.
- Align all assessment practices with **ASNEB, KCDACC, KNEC, or university guidelines**.
- Maintain **academic credibility and transparency** in the evaluation process.

Types of Student Assessment

Assessment at Ruralnet is continuous and multi-dimensional. It combines both **formative (ongoing)** and **summative (final)** assessments.

a. Continuous Assessment (Formative)

- Conducted throughout the course duration to monitor student progress.
- Includes **class tests, assignments, group projects, practical exercises, quizzes, and presentations**.
- Encourages students to improve learning through regular feedback.

b. Final Examination (Summative)

- Conducted at the end of the learning period to evaluate cumulative knowledge and skills.
- Includes PowerPoint practical assessment that contains six slides;
    - The first slide contains the tittle 'MY EXPERIENCE AT RURALNET TRAINING COLLEGE' and subtitle containing student's name,
    - Slide two contains list of contents learnt while at ruralnet
    - Slide three contains what pleased the student while pursuing his/her course

- Slide four contains what the student expected to learn but they didn't get the concept, and the ones covered but not well understood.
- Slide five contains challenges faced while studying at Ruralnet Training College
- Slide six contains recommendations on the above challenges for improvement.
- The last slide contains designed pictures of what they learnt

- The presentation is then styled
- Finally, it is sent to Ruralnet's official email; (ruralnet2016@gmail.com)

c. KASNEB and Competency-Based Assessment (CBA) – For TVET/CDACC

- Based on **demonstration of specific competencies** or skills.
- Students must show mastery in performing given accounting and ICT tasks or projects.
- Uses **observation checklists, portfolios, and performance evidence**.

Assessment Principles

All assessments must follow these guiding principles:

- **Validity:** Tests what it is intended to test (e.g., programming skills through coding tasks).
- **Reliability:** Produces consistent results across assessors and settings.
- **Fairness:** Free from bias and accessible to all learners.
- **Transparency:** Students are informed about assessment criteria and grading systems in advance.
- **Accountability:** Trainers maintain proper records of student marks and feedback.

Moderation of Assessments

Moderation ensures that assessments and results are consistent, objective, and meet institutional and national standards. It is carried out at different levels.

a. Internal Moderation

- Conducted within the college by experienced trainers or Heads of Department (HODs).
- Involves reviewing:

  - Examination questions and marking schemes before exams.
  - Sample marked scripts and projects after grading.

- Ensures uniformity in marking and fairness in grading among different trainers.
- Addresses any discrepancies before results are finalized.

b. External Moderation

- Conducted by **external moderators** appointed by **KASNEB and VET-CDACC, KNEC**, or **university partners**.
- Verifies that internal assessments meet required national and professional standards.
- Confirms fairness and accuracy of student marks and reports.
- Provides recommendations for improvement in future assessments.

Feedback and Continuous Improvement

- Students receive **timely and constructive feedback** to help them identify strengths and areas for improvement.
- Trainers use assessment outcomes to **adjust teaching methods** and address learning gaps.
- The institution periodically reviews its assessment tools and processes based on moderation reports and performance trends.

Assessment Records Management

- All student assessment records (marks, scripts, practical reports, portfolios) are securely stored and backed up.
- Access to these records is restricted to authorized academic staff.
- Records are retained for a period of 5 months from the time of course completion for audit and verification purposes.

Special Considerations

- Students with valid reasons (e.g., illness, disability, bereavement) are allowed **special assessments or extensions**, upon approval by the CEO
- Any cases of **academic dishonesty** (cheating, plagiarism, collusion) are handled under the institution's **Academic Integrity Policy** and attract disciplinary action.

Research and Innovation Policy

This section outlines the framework through which the ICT college promotes, manages, and supports **research, innovation, and creative problem-solving** among staff and students. It ensures that all research and innovation activities contribute to **technological advancement, academic excellence, and community development**.

The Research and Innovation Policy aims to:

- Promote a **culture of inquiry, creativity, and technological innovation** within the college.
- Encourage **evidence-based research** that addresses real-world ICT and socio-economic challenges.
- Strengthen **industry-academia collaboration** to enhance applied research and innovation.
- Guide ethical research conduct and protect intellectual property rights.

Objectives

- To support **staff and student participation** in research and innovation activities.
- To establish a structured process for **proposal development, funding, implementation, and dissemination**.
- To ensure that research aligns with **national priorities**, institutional goals, and **TVET/CDACC or university standards**.
- To promote the development of **ICT-based solutions** for community and industry needs.
- To recognize and reward **innovative ideas, prototypes, and publications**.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All **academic and technical staff** conducting research or supervising projects.
- All **students** undertaking final-year or competency-based innovation projects.
- **Collaborative projects** involving external partners, industries, or funding agencies.
- Institutional **research centers, innovation hubs, and incubators** established for technology development.

Research Focus Areas

Ruralnet ICT prioritizes research and innovation in emerging ICT and related fields such as:

- Software development and systems engineering.
- Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Data Science.
- Cybersecurity and ethical hacking.
- Computer networking and cloud computing.
- Internet of Things (IoT) and embedded systems.
- Digital literacy, e-learning technologies, and ICT for development.
- Green computing and sustainable ICT practices.
- Finance and accounting advancements

- Managerial Accounting
- Auditing and Assurance
- Taxation
- Accounting Information System (AIS)
- Corporate governance and ethics

Research and Innovation Structure

To manage research activities effectively, Ruralnet establishes:

- A **Research and Innovation Committee (RIC)** or **Directorate**, responsible for:
    - Approving research proposals.
    - Overseeing project implementation and reporting.
    - Managing research ethics compliance.
- **Departmental Research Coordinators**, who:
    - Guide students and staff on proposal writing.
    - Coordinate departmental innovation projects.
- **Innovation Hubs or Labs**, where students can prototype and test their ICT solutions.

Funding and Resource Support

- Ruralnet allocates an **annual research and innovation budget**.
- Partnerships with industries provide **mentorship, equipment, and internship opportunities**.
- Access to **digital libraries, ICT infrastructure, and laboratories** supports research activities.
- For accounting courses;

Funding Type	Source Examples	Usage
Institutional Funding	Ruralnet budgets, academic councils	Faculty salaries, course materials
Government Grants	Education ministries, research councils	Curriculum dev., research, public accounting
Industry & Professional	ACCA, CPA firms, corporate sponsors	Guest speakers, internships, sponsorships
International Donors	World Bank, IMF, OECD, UNDP	Public sector/governance accounting

Philanthropy	Alumni, foundations	Scholarships, professorships, tech labs
Student-Focused Resources	Scholarships, exam prep, digital tools	Tuition help, academic success

Research Ethics and Integrity

All research must adhere to high ethical standards, including:

- **Honesty and transparency** in data collection, analysis, and reporting.
- **Respect for intellectual property rights** and proper acknowledgment of sources.
- **Informed consent** and confidentiality in research involving human participants.
- **Prohibition of plagiarism, data falsification, or fabrication**.
- Compliance with institutional and national research ethics guidelines.

Research Dissemination

- Research outcomes are shared through **seminars, conferences, journals, and online platforms**.
- The institution may publish a **college research journal or newsletter**.
- Staff and students are encouraged to present papers at **local and international conferences**.
- Partnerships with other academic and professional institutions promote **knowledge exchange**.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Recognition

- The Research and Innovation Committee regularly evaluates research outputs and impact.
- Successful projects are recognized through **awards, certificates, or promotions**.
- Findings from research are used to **improve curriculum, teaching methods, and institutional development**.

Link with Academic Programs

- Research is integrated into teaching and learning, particularly through **capstone assignments**, and **competency-based assessments**.
- Students are guided by qualified supervisors to ensure **methodological rigor and originality**.
- Research findings are used to **update course content** and maintain curriculum relevance.

Academic Integrity (Anti-Plagiarism, Ethical ICT Use)

This section establishes the standards of **honesty, responsibility, and ethical behavior** expected of all students and staff in academic and research activities. It ensures that all work submitted or performed represents **original effort** and upholds the **values of professionalism and integrity** at Ruralnet Training College.

The purpose of the Academic Integrity Policy is to:

- Promote **honest scholarship** and **ethical academic conduct**.
- Prevent and address **academic dishonesty**, **plagiarism**, and **misuse of ICT resources**.
- Foster a culture of **trust, accountability, and professionalism** within Ruralnet
- Ensure compliance with **institutional regulations** and **national academic standards**.

Principles of Academic Integrity

All members of the college community—students, lecturers, and researchers—are expected to:

- Produce and present **original work**.
- **Acknowledge** all sources of information, data, and ideas appropriately.
- Use **ICT tools and resources responsibly**.
- Avoid any behavior that undermines **fairness, honesty, and academic standards**.
- Respect **intellectual property rights** and confidentiality in academic work.

Forms of Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct includes;

a. Plagiarism

- Presenting another person's ideas, words, or digital content as one's own without proper citation.
- Copying from websites, journals, reports, or classmates without acknowledgment.
- Submitting work generated by AI or software without disclosure or permission.

b. Cheating in Examinations or Tests

- Possessing unauthorized materials during exams.
- Communicating with others or using devices (phones, smartwatches) to gain unfair advantage.
- Impersonating another candidate or colluding in exam irregularities.

c. Fabrication or Falsification

- Making up data, results, or citations in projects or reports.
- Altering marks, attendance, or academic records.

d. Unauthorized Collaboration

- Working with others on assignments meant to be done individually.
- Sharing confidential exam questions or solutions.

e. Misuse of ICT Resources

- Using institutional computers or networks for unethical or illegal activities such as hacking, piracy, or spreading malware.
- Accessing or sharing restricted data without authorization.
- Installing unauthorized software or bypassing security systems.

Anti-Plagiarism Measures

- All academic work (assignments, research projects, reports, and theses) must be **checked using plagiarism detection tools** such as Turnitin, Grammarly, or institutional software.
- Acceptable **similarity index**:
  - **Below 20%** for student work (unless otherwise specified).
- Trainers must educate students on **proper citation and referencing techniques** (American Psychological Association, Modern Language Association, or Harvard style).

Ethical Use of ICT Resources

Ruralnet provides ICT resources (computers, internet, software, and e-learning platforms) for **academic and professional development**. Users must:

- Access only authorized systems and data.
- Avoid downloading and watching/listening to videos and music
- Avoid downloading or sharing pirated software.
- Use institutional email and online platforms for **official and educational purposes**.
- Maintain **cybersecurity awareness**, including safeguarding passwords and personal data.
- Report any **security breaches or unethical digital behavior** to the ICT department.

Academic Integrity Training and Awareness

- All new students and staff undergo **orientation on academic ethics and ICT responsibility**.

- Regular **seminars and workshops** are held to promote awareness of plagiarism, intellectual property rights, and digital ethics.
- The institution provides guides and resources on **ethical research writing and ICT usage**.

Disciplinary Actions for Academic Misconduct

Violations of academic integrity are treated seriously and may lead to disciplinary measures such as:

- **Written warning or deduction of marks** for minor offenses.
- **Cancellation of an exam or project** in cases of confirmed cheating or plagiarism.
- **Suspension or expulsion** for repeated or severe violations.
- **Withdrawal of certificates or transcripts** if misconduct is discovered after completion of studies.

Continuous Improvement

- The institution reviews its academic integrity and ICT ethics policies yearly.
- Feedback from staff, students, and regulators helps refine the policy to match **emerging technologies** (AI tools, cloud computing, cybersecurity challenges).
- Promotes a **culture of responsibility, innovation, and ethical professionalism** among graduates.

CHAPTER FIVE

STUDENT AFFAIRS POLICY

The **Student Affairs Policy** provides guidelines for managing all **non-academic aspects** of student life at Ruralnet Training College
It ensures that students learn in a **safe, supportive, and inclusive environment** that promotes personal growth, discipline, leadership, and innovation alongside academic achievement.

Objectives of the Policy

The main objectives of the Student Affairs Policy are to:

1. Promote the **welfare, safety, and holistic development** of students.

2. Ensure **effective student representation and participation** in institutional governance.
3. Maintain **discipline, integrity, and ethical conduct** among students.
4. Provide **support services** that enhance learning, career growth, and personal wellbeing.
5. Encourage **co-curricular and extra-curricular engagement** to build soft skills and leadership capacity.
6. Foster a **culture of innovation, responsibility, and citizenship** in line with ICT professionalism.

Admission and Registration Procedures

The **Admission and Registration Procedures** outline the guidelines for admitting and enrolling students into various ICT programs.
They ensure that the process is **transparent, merit-based, and compliant** with the standards set by relevant regulatory bodies such as **TVET/CDACC, KASNEB**, **KNEC**, and the **Ministry of Education**.

This policy guarantees fairness, equal opportunity, and accountability in admitting students to certificate, diploma, and higher diploma programs.

The objectives of the admission and registration policy are to:

1. Maintain **standardized procedures** for admitting qualified applicants.
2. Ensure that **entry requirements** meet accreditation and national education standards.
3. Promote **transparency and fairness** in student selection.
4. Ensure **accurate data management** of student records.
5. Support students through a **smooth transition** from admission to academic registration.

Admission Policy

Admission Principles

- Admission is based on **academic merit**, **eligibility**, and **availability of space** in the chosen program.
- The institution upholds the principles of **equity, inclusivity, and non-discrimination** regardless of gender, religion, or background.
- All applicants must meet the **minimum entry requirements** approved by **TVET/CDACC** or **KNEC**.
- The college reserves the right to **verify academic documents** and reject falsified credentials.

Entry Requirements for computer Courses

Entry requirements vary depending on the program level and regulatory body.

Level / Course Type	What it is	Usual Minimum Requirements
Short / Certificate courses (e.g. basic ICT skills, computer applications)	Very introductory skills: ➢ Introduction, ➢ Microsoft Office, ➢ Basic hardware/software, ➢ Internet, ➢ Software installation.	Basic pass in **KCSE and above.**
ICT Technician / Craft Certificate Level 5	➢ Apply Basic Electronics ➢ Develop Computer Program ➢ Install Computer Software ➢ Manage Database Systems ➢ Manage Operating System ➢ Perform Computer Repair and Maintenance	KCSE minimum grade **D plain** Certified Level 4 artisan certificate (ICT Level 4) or previous ICT certificate plus some experience.
Diploma in ICT / ICT Technician Diploma	➢ Apply Basic Electronics ➢ Control ICT Security Threats ➢ Develop Computer Program ➢ Install Computer Software ➢ Manage Database Systems ➢ Manage Information System ➢ Mobile Application Development ➢ Perform Computer Networking ➢ Perform Computer Repair and Maintenance ➢ Perform Graphic Design ➢ Perform ICT System Support ➢ Perform System Analysis and Design ➢ Perform Website Design	KCSE with at least **C- (C Minus)** Craft certificate or equivalent ICT-level certificate (Level 5) from recognized institutions.

Entry Requirements for KASNEB/Accounting Courses

Course	Full Name / Abbreviation	Typical Minimum Entry Requirements
CAMS (Certificate in Accounting & Management Skills)	**CAMS**	➢ Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE) grade **D & Above**.
ATD (Accounting Technicians Diploma)	ATD	➢ KCSE with a mean grade of **C--** (C Minus) or equivalent. ➢ OR a certificate such as Accounting & Management Skills (CAMS) or other technician/diploma certificate recognized by KASNEB.
CPA (Certified Public Accountant)	CPA	➢ KCSE with an aggregate average of at least **C+**. ➢ KACE (Kenya Advanced Certificate of Education) with at least **two Principal passes**, with good scores in Mathematics and English at KCE or equivalent. ➢ A diploma or professional examination certificate (technician or equivalent) from KASNEB or recognized institution. ➢ A degree from a recognized university. ➢ IGCSE grade C in 6 papers with C in both English & Mathematics.
CIFA (Certified Investment & Financial Analysts)	CIFA	➢ KCSE mean grade **C+** or equivalent. ➢ Also accepts a professional qualification (e.g. another KASNEB professional certificate or diploma) or a degree from a recognized university.
Computerized Accounting	(Short course or Certificate in Computerised Accounting)	➢ B**asic pass in KCSE**, ➢ Basic mathematics and some computer skills.

Admission Procedure

The admission process generally follows these steps:

Step 1: Application

- Prospective students obtain an **application form** (from RuralNet portal or for those making physical inquiries, their details are captured by the recruiting officer or staff).

- Applicants fill in their details, attach certified academic certificates, ID copies, and passport-size photographs.
- A **non-refundable application fee** (included in the fees as per the course) must be paid.

Step 2: Verification of Documents

- The admissions office verifies all academic and identification documents.
- Applications that meet the requirements are forwarded to the **Academic Board** for approval.
- Fraudulent or incomplete applications are rejected.

Step 3: Selection and Admission

- Successful applicants receive an **official admission letter** specifying:
    - Course admitted to
    - Reporting date
    - Duration of study
    - Fees structure and payment schedule
    - Required materials (e.g., laptop, uniform, or tools)
- Admission may be offered on a **first-come, first-served basis** where space is limited.

Step 4: Orientation

- Newly admitted students undergo an **orientation program** to familiarize them with:
    - Academy rules and regulations
    - Academic structure and examination policies
    - ICT facilities, e-learning platforms, and student services
    - Code of conduct, health, and safety policies

Registration Procedure

Once admitted, students must complete formal registration to become active members of the institution.

a. Requirements for Registration

- Valid **admission letter**.
- Proof of **fee payment or installment plan**.
- **Certified copies** of academic certificates and identification documents.
- **Two passport-size photographs**.
- Signed copies of the **student declaration form**, **code of conduct**, and **ICT usage policy**.

b. Registration Steps

1. Report to the **Admissions Office** with the required documents.
2. Verify personal and course details in the Management Information System (MIS)
3. Receive **student admission number and ID card**.
4. Register online or manually for the semester units or modules.
5. Receive access credentials to **e-learning systems and ICT labs**.

Record Management

- The Admissions Office maintains **confidential student records** — personal data, academic history, and registration details.
- Student information is stored in a secure **Management Information System (MIS)**.
- Access to data is restricted to authorized staff in compliance with data protection laws.

Withdrawal or Discontinuation

- A student wishing to withdraw must submit a **written notification** to the instructor.
- Ruralnet may discontinue a student due to:
    - Academic failure
    - Misconduct
    - Non-payment of fees
    - Absenteeism beyond allowable limits (One week)

Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules

The **Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules** establish the expected standards of behavior, ethics, and responsibility among students within Ruralnet. It ensures a safe, respectful, and conducive environment for learning, innovation, and personal growth. Its main purpose is;

- To promote discipline, integrity, and accountability among students.
- To maintain harmony and respect among students, staff, and the institution.
- To safeguard the institution's reputation and uphold its core values.
- To guide corrective measures when rules or ethical standards are violated.

General Conduct Expectations

All students must:

- Adhere to all **institutional rules and regulations**.
- Show **respect** to trainers, staff, and fellow students.
- Uphold **honesty, fairness, and responsibility** in all academic and social activities.
- Observe **punctuality and regular attendance** in classes, examinations, and official events.
- Take good care of **college property, ICT equipment, and facilities**.
- Dress **appropriately and decently** within the learning environment to avoid distractions during learning process.
- Comply with **ICT usage policies**, including responsible internet and device use.

Academic Integrity and conduct

- **Plagiarism, cheating, and impersonation** during exams or assignments are strictly prohibited.
- Students must properly acknowledge all **sources, software, and projects** used in academic work.
- **Collusion** (unauthorized cooperation) is treated as a serious academic offense.
- Breaches of academic integrity may lead to disciplinary action, including suspension or expulsion.
- Use computers, internet access, and digital platforms **only for educational purposes**.
- Avoid **cyberbullying, hacking, or misuse of digital resources**.
- Respect **data privacy, intellectual property, and cybersecurity ethics**.
- Not install, modify, or delete institutional software without permission.
- Report any system abuse or security breach immediately to ICT administration.

Social and Behavioral Conduct

Students shall:

- Refrain from **fighting, harassment, discrimination, or intimidation** of any kind.
- Avoid **drug and alcohol abuse**, smoking, or illegal activities within campus premises.
- Maintain **peaceful coexistence** and resolve conflicts through dialogue or official channels.
- Respect **gender equality and diversity**.
- Abstain from political activities or demonstrations that disrupt academic operations.

Attendance and Punctuality

- Regular attendance is mandatory for all academic sessions and examinations.
- Absence without valid reason or permission may lead to disciplinary warning or exclusion.
- Students must sign class attendance registers and be punctual for lessons and ICT sessions.

Disciplinary Procedures

When a student violates the code of conduct:

1. **Reporting:** The case is reported to the Trainer who carries the matter to the admin.
2. **Investigation:** Admin investigates the issue fairly and confidentially.
3. **Hearing:** The student is given a chance to explain or defend themselves.
4. **Verdict and Sanction:** Depending on the severity, penalties includes:

    - Verbal or written warning
    - Suspension
    - Restitution (paying for damage or loss)
    - Dismissal or expulsion

Appeals Process

- A student dissatisfied with a disciplinary decision may **appeal in writing** to the Academic head within3 days.
- The appeal must provide **valid reasons or new evidence** for reconsideration.

Recognition and Positive Conduct

- Students who consistently demonstrate **exemplary behavior, leadership, and discipline** receives commendations or awards.
- Ruralnet ICT also grant **leadership positions** or **certificates of good conduct** to such students.

Student Welfare Policy (Counseling, Health, and Accommodation)

The Student Welfare Policy ensures that all learners enjoy a **safe, supportive, and healthy environment** that promotes **academic success, emotional stability, and personal growth**. It recognizes that students' well-being is essential for effective learning and holistic development. Its main aim is;

- To provide **psychological and emotional support** through counseling services.
- To promote **physical health, safety, and wellness** on campus.
- To ensure **adequate, affordable, and secure accommodation** for students.
- To foster a **student-centered environment** that encourages productivity, discipline, and self-care.
- To enhance **retention and success** by addressing non-academic challenges.

A. Counseling Services

This is done by the institution manager who may sometimes invites other proffessionals to offer various counseling services. CEO/Manager oversees such activities and monitors outcomes.

- **Academic Counseling:** Guidance on study habits, time management, exam anxiety, and career choices.
- **Personal Counseling:** Support for emotional, family, or relationship issues.
- **Career Guidance:** Mentorship and advice on ICT-related career paths, internships, and job preparation.
- **Crisis Intervention:** Immediate assistance for students facing trauma, depression, or other emergencies.

CHAPTER SIX:

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE AND RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

The **Infrastructure and Resource Management Policy** ensures that the institution's **physical, technological, and learning resources** are properly planned, developed, maintained, and utilized to support **quality education, innovation, and operational efficiency**.

It focuses on creating a **safe, modern, and ICT-enabled environment** conducive to teaching, learning, and research.

Objectives

- To establish **effective management** and **optimal utilization** of all institutional resources.
- To ensure **adequate and up-to-date ICT infrastructure** to meet academic and administrative needs.
- To maintain **safety, sustainability, and accessibility** in all college facilities.
- To promote **asset accountability** and transparency in resource allocation.

- To continuously **upgrade facilities** in line with technological advancement and educational standards.

Management of Computer Labs and Equipment Policy

This section ensures **efficient, secure, and sustainable use** of computer laboratories and ICT equipment within Ruralnet Training College.
It provides clear guidelines for **maintenance, access control, usage ethics, and resource accountability** to support teaching, learning, and research.

Computer Lab Administration

- **ICT Officer** is responsible for daily operations, maintenance, and supervision.
- The **Head of ICT Department** oversees all labs and ensures compliance with institutional ICT policies.
- A **lab usage timetable** must be available always to coordinate class schedules, free access hours, and special sessions.
- Only **authorized students, trainers, and staff** may use the labs.
- For now, entry requires manual attendance register, but with time, an entry system for student will be developed.
- Access outside official hours in not allowed unless authorized by ICT officer.
- Visitors or external users must obtain clearance from administration.

Usage Guidelines

- Labs must be used **strictly for academic and research purposes** — not for gaming, social media, or personal entertainment.
- Users must **sign in and sign out** in the attendance register or system.
- Eating, drinking, or smoking in labs is **strictly prohibited**.
- Students must **maintain cleanliness** and orderliness at their workstations.
- All users must **log off and shut down computers properly** after use.

- Only **authorized software** installed by the ICT department must be used.
- Installation, modification, or deletion of programs is **prohibited** unless approved by the ICT officer.
- Users must **not alter system configurations** or attempt to bypass security measures.
- Personal devices (USB drives, external disks) must be **scanned for viruses** before connection; only from ICT officer.
- Internet access is primarily for **research, learning, and institutional communication**.
- **Cyberbullying, hacking, or downloading illegal content** is strictly prohibited.
- Users must comply with the institution's **Cybersecurity and Acceptable Use Policy**.
- Bandwidth-heavy activities are restricted to ensure fair use.

Maintenance and Technical Support

Preventive Maintenance

- Regular **inspection, cleaning, and updating** of hardware and software must be done on a monthly basis.
- Antivirus programs and system updates should be kept current.
- Faulty equipment should be reported immediately to the **Lab Technician** and recorded in the **maintenance logbook**.

Repairs and Replacements

- Minor faults are handled internally by the ICT team.
- Major repairs or replacements require **administrative approval and documentation**.
- Obsolete or irreparable equipment is **decommissioned responsibly** following e-waste guidelines.

Inventory and Asset Management

- Each item (computer, monitor, router, projector, etc.) must have a **unique asset tag**.
- The ICT Department maintains an **inventory register** indicating serial numbers, purchase date, and current condition.
- Annual **physical verification and audits** ensure accountability and prevent loss.

Safety and Security Measures

Physical Security

- Labs must be **locked and alarmed** when not in use.
- All laptop and computer equipment must be kept back in their respective places after use.
- **CCTV cameras** may be installed for surveillance and asset protection.
- Only authorized personnel may access **network servers, storage rooms, and power panels**.

Health and Safety

- Proper **ventilation and lighting** must be maintained.
- **Ergonomic furniture** should be used to reduce strain during long computer sessions.
- **Fire extinguishers** and **emergency exits** must be clearly marked and functional.
- Students must be trained on **basic lab safety and emergency procedures**.

Training and Support

- Students receive **orientation** on lab rules, ICT ethics, and data security at the start of each term.
- Lab technicians and trainers undergo **continuous ICT training** to stay updated with emerging technologies.
- Ruralnet ICT promotes **ICT literacy programs** for both staff and students.

Monitoring and Evaluation

- Lab usage and performance shall be **monitored through** manual reports.
- Feedback is collected from users to identify **areas for improvement**.
- Periodic evaluations guide decisions on **upgrades, budgeting, and resource expansion**.

Software Licensing and Maintenance Policy

The **Software Licensing and Maintenance Policy** ensures that all software used within the Ruralnet is **legal, secure, properly maintained, and up-to-date**.
It aims to promote **compliance with intellectual property laws**, prevent cybersecurity risks, and support the institution's **academic and administrative efficiency**. The main aim is;

- To ensure that all software is **genuinely acquired and properly licensed**.
- To define procedures for **installation, maintenance, and updates** of institutional software.
- To protect the institution from **legal, financial, and security risks** related to unlicensed software.
- To promote the use of **open-source and educational software** where appropriate.
- To maintain **system reliability and user productivity** through regular updates and support.

Software Acquisition and Licensing

- All software acquisitions must go through the **ICT Department** and follow institutional procurement procedures.
- Software must be purchased only from **authorized vendors or developers**.
- Each software must have **valid license documentation**, including:

    - License certificate or key
    - Proof of purchase (invoice or receipt)
    - Version and expiry details

- The ICT Officer maintains a **Software License Register** containing all this information.
- **No software shall be acquired through illegal means; by hacking, cracking or unauthorized software piracy.**

Types of Software Licensing

Type	Description
Proprietary Software	Commercial software with paid licenses (e.g., Microsoft Office, Adobe, AutoCAD, QuickBooks, printer keys, Photoshop).
Open-Source Software	Free software that can be used and customized under open licenses (e.g., SQL, win11, Xamp, Visual studio, Web browsers, 360TS, LibreOffice).
Educational Licenses	Academic or discounted versions for institutions (e.g., Microsoft Academic, Autodesk Education).
Subscription-Based	Software paid for on a renewable monthly or yearly basis (e.g., Office 365, cloud tools, Namecheap domain, Quickbooks).

- Software installation without proper authorization or license is **strictly prohibited**.
- Periodic **software audits** shall be conducted to verify compliance annually.
- Expired or unused licenses must be **renewed, transferred, or deactivated** as appropriate.
- Copying, sharing, or distributing licensed software without permission is a **disciplinary and legal offense**.

Software Installation and Configuration

- Only **ICT officer** should install or configure software.
- Each installation must follow the **standardized setup checklist** to ensure compatibility and security.
- Personal software installations by students on institutional devices are **not allowed** unless approved.
- Any installation on lab computers must maintain **uniform configurations** for easier management and troubleshooting.
- The ICT Department shall keep **records of installed versions** and ensure compatibility with operating systems and hardware.
- Outdated or unsupported software must be **phased out** systematically to avoid security vulnerabilities.

Software Maintenance and Updates

Regular Updates

All institutional computers must have **weekly updates** for:

- Operating systems
- Security patches
- Applications and utilities

Technical Support

- The ICT Department provides **routine maintenance and troubleshooting** for all software-related issues.
- Maintenance logs must record:
    - Software problems encountered
    - Actions taken
    - Date and person responsible
    - Funds incurred
- Vendors or developers may be contacted for **specialized support** when under warranty or service contract.

Backup and Data Protection

- Critical systems (e.g., databases, ERP, LMS) contain **backups** stored securely on servers laptop (No. 12 [Source File]) and RuralNet drive account.
- Backups must be tested periodically to ensure recoverability.
- Security software (antivirus, firewall) must be **weekly updated** to protect against threats.

Open Source and Institutional Software Policy

- The institution encourages the use of **open-source software** for educational and cost-saving purposes where feasible.
- Custom institutional software (MIS, e-learning platform, and accounts available on the website) shall be:
    - Properly documented
    - Maintained by an ICT officer
    - Regularly reviewed for performance and security

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
ICT Officer	Approve installations, maintain software inventory, ensure compliance, and manage updates.

Users (Staff/Students)	Use software responsibly, report issues, and avoid tampering or piracy.
College Administration	Provide budget allocation for software renewal and upgrades. Verify vendor authenticity and ensure proper license documentation during purchase.

Monitoring and Compliance

- The ICT Department conducts **annual software audits** to verify compliance.
- Any unauthorized or pirated software discovered will be **immediately uninstalled** and reported. The individual involved will be charged to pay a fee of Kshs. 2,000

Disposal: Safe Decommissioning of Obsolete ICT Assets

This policy outlines how Ruralnet responsibly disposes of outdated, damaged, or obsolete ICT equipment and materials. The goal is to ensure **data security, environmental sustainability, and compliance with legal and Ruralnet regulations**.

Identification of Obsolete ICT Assets

- ICT equipment such as **computers, servers, printers, routers, and storage devices** are monthly assessed to determine usability and efficiency.
- Assets are classified as obsolete when they:
    - No longer meet operational or academic requirements.
    - Are beyond economical repair.
    - Are incompatible with current systems or software.
    - Pose maintenance or security challenges.
- The ICT department prepares an **asset decommissioning report** listing items recommended for disposal, approved by management.

Data Security and Sanitization

- Before disposal, all storage media (hard drives, SSDs, USBs, etc.) are **securely wiped, degaussed, or physically destroyed** to prevent data recovery.
- Sensitive institutional or student data is handled in accordance with the **Data Protection Act (Kenya, 2019){Attached at the end of this policy}**. Certified data destruction tools

and methods are used, and a **data destruction certificate** is maintained for accountability.

Environmental Considerations (E-Waste Management)

- Disposal processes comply with **National Environment Management Authority (NEMA)** guidelines and **e-waste management regulations**.
- Reusable components are salvaged and repurposed where possible.
- Non-repairable equipment is handed over to **licensed e-waste recyclers or collection centers**.
- The college promotes environmentally responsible practices to reduce electronic waste and pollution.

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4. Disposal Authorization and Documentation

- Disposal is carried out only after **formal approval** from the institution's management or board.
- A disposal committee oversees the process to ensure transparency and accountability.
- Detailed records are kept, including:
  - Asset identification details (model, serial number).
  - Disposal method (reuse, recycle, destruction).
  - Date and responsible officer.
- A **disposal certificate** is issued and filed for auditing and compliance purposes.

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5. Reuse, Donation, and Resale

- Equipment that is still functional but outdated may be:
  - **Donated** to community ICT training centers, schools, or NGOs.
  - **Repurposed** for less demanding administrative or training tasks.
  - **Sold** through approved public disposal procedures (in line with Public Procurement and Asset Disposal Act, 2015).

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6. Responsibility

- The **ICT Manager** is responsible for coordinating the decommissioning process.
- The **Procurement and Finance departments** oversee asset valuation and disposal compliance.
- All staff must ensure that ICT resources are not abandoned, misused, or disposed of without proper authorization.

Internet Access and Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)

This policy defines the **responsible, ethical, and secure use of internet services** provided by the ICT college. It ensures that internet access supports **teaching, learning, research, and administration** while protecting users, systems, and the institution from misuse and security threats.

Internet Access Provision

- Internet access is provided **primarily for academic, research, and administrative purposes**.
- Users are issued **unique login credentials** or Wi-Fi passwords and are responsible for their use.
- Guest access is provided on a **restricted and temporary basis** upon authorization.
- Bandwidth is managed to prioritize **learning platforms, research resources, and institutional systems**.

Acceptable Use

Users are allowed to:

- Access online academic resources, journals, e-learning platforms, and educational websites.
- Use email, cloud tools, and collaboration platforms for academic and institutional communication.
- Download software or materials **approved and relevant** to coursework or institutional work.
- Conduct research and innovation activities within legal and ethical boundaries.

5. Unacceptable Use

The following activities are strictly prohibited:

- Accessing or distributing **illegal, obscene, or offensive content**.
- Engaging in **cybercrime**, including hacking, phishing, malware distribution, or identity theft.
- Excessive use of bandwidth for non-academic activities (e.g., gaming, streaming, torrents).
- Using the internet for **harassment, bullying, hate speech, or defamation**.
- Downloading or sharing **pirated software, movies, or music**.
- Attempting to bypass network security, filters, or access controls.

6. Security and Privacy

- Users must not share login credentials or access another user's account.
- Personal data and institutional information must be handled in line with **data protection laws**.
- The institution reserves the right to **monitor network traffic** to ensure security and policy compliance, while respecting user privacy.
- Users must report suspected **security incidents or misuse** to the ICT department immediately.

7. User Responsibilities

- Use the internet responsibly and ethically at all times.
- Protect devices from malware by avoiding unsafe websites and downloads.
- Log out of shared computers after use.
- Comply with all ICT-related policies, including cybersecurity and academic integrity policies.

8. Enforcement and Sanctions

- Violations of this policy may result in:
  - Temporary or permanent suspension of internet access.
  - Disciplinary action under student or staff regulations.
  - Legal action in cases involving criminal activity.
- Repeat offenders may face **demotion by the staff and suspension from the institution by students.**

Network Security and Data Privacy Policy

This policy establishes measures to protect the ICT college's **network infrastructure, information systems, and personal data** from unauthorized access, misuse, loss, or cyber threats. It ensures **confidentiality, integrity, and availability** of data in compliance with legal and ethical standards.

Network Security Measures

Access Control

- Network access is restricted to **authorized users only**.
- Strong authentication methods (password policies, multi-factor authentication where applicable) are enforced.
- User access rights are assigned based on **roles and responsibilities**.

Network Protection

- Firewalls, intrusion detection/prevention systems (IDS/IPS), and antivirus software are deployed and regularly updated.
- Networks are segmented (e.g., staff, students, guests) to reduce security risks.
- Regular vulnerability assessments and security audits are conducted.

Monitoring and Logging

- Network activity is monitored to detect **unauthorized access, attacks, or misuse**.
- System logs are maintained for audit and investigation purposes.
- Monitoring is conducted in accordance with privacy and legal requirements.

Data Privacy and Protection

Data Classification

- Data is classified as **public, internal, confidential, or sensitive**.
- Sensitive data (e.g., student records, staff files, examination data) receives the highest level of protection.

Data Handling and Storage

- Personal and confidential data must be stored in **secure systems** with restricted access.
- Data encryption is used for sensitive data stored or transmitted over networks.
- Physical access to servers and data centers is strictly controlled.

Data Sharing

- Personal data is shared only with **authorized parties** and for legitimate purposes.
- Third-party access requires formal agreements and compliance with data protection standards.

User Responsibilities

- Users must protect login credentials and avoid sharing passwords.
- Personal devices connected to the network must meet **minimum security standards such as**:
  - ❖ Updated operating system.
  - ❖ Antivirus protection
  - ❖ Strong passwords.
  - ❖ Firewall enabled.
  - ❖ Data encryption.
  - ❖ Screen lock.
  - ❖ No harmful software.

- Users must immediately report **data breaches, suspicious activity, or security incidents**.

- Staff and students must comply with institutional policies on data handling and ICT ethics.

Incident Response and Recovery

- Any incident must be reported to immediate staff to help manage security breaches or data loss.
- Incidents are documented, investigated, and corrective actions implemented.
- Regular backups and system checks ensure quick recovery from system failures or cyberattacks.

Legal and Regulatory Compliance

- The institution complies with:
  - ❖ NITA Act
  - ❖ TVET Act
  - ❖ Education
  - ❖ Labour Act
  - ❖ Public Finance Management Act
  - ❖ Employemnt Act
  - ❖ Work Injury Benefits Act

Training and Awareness

- Regular training is provided on **cybersecurity best practices and data privacy**.
- Awareness programs educate users on phishing, malware, and safe internet behavior.

Policy Enforcement and Review

- Violations may result in disciplinary or legal action.
- The policy is reviewed periodically to address evolving cyber threats and technological changes.

ICT Support Services Policy (Helpdesk, Backups, and Repairs)

This policy defines how the ICT college provides **technical support services** to ensure reliable, efficient, and uninterrupted use of ICT systems. It covers **user support, data protection, and equipment maintenance**, which are essential for effective teaching, learning, and administration.

ICT Helpdesk Services

Helpdesk Functions

- The ICT Helpdesk serves as the **first point of contact** for all ICT-related issues. H.O.D ICT will be handling this office.
- Services provided include:
    - User account and password support
    - Software and system troubleshooting
    - Network and internet connectivity issues
    - Hardware and peripheral support
    - Access to institutional systems (LMS, email, ERP)

Support Channels

- Support requests may be submitted through:
    - Walk-in helpdesk
    - Email or ticketing system
    - phones or internal communication platforms
- All requests are **logged, tracked, and prioritized** based on urgency and impact.

Response and Resolution

- Issues are categorized as **critical, high, medium, or low priority**.
- Target response times are defined to ensure service quality.
- Unresolved or complex issues are escalated to **senior ICT staff or external vendors**.

Data Backup and Recovery

Backup Procedures

- Monthly backups are conducted for:
    - Student records
    - Academic data and examinations
    - Financial and administrative systems
- Backup copies are stored securely on:
    - On-site servers and cloud storage
    - Off-site locations

4.2 Data Recovery

- Data restoration is performed promptly in cases of:
    - System failure
    - Accidental deletion
    - Cyber incidents
- Backup systems are tested periodically to ensure reliability and completeness.

ICT Equipment Repairs and Maintenance

Repair Procedures

- All faulty ICT equipment must be reported to the ICT department immediately.
- Repairs are handled by
    - In-house ICT technicians
    - Authorized service providers and technicians for other and/or warranty-covered issues
- Users are prohibited from attempting self-repairs on institutional equipment.

Preventive Maintenance

- Scheduled maintenance helps reduce breakdowns and prolong equipment lifespan.
- Maintenance activities include:
    - Hardware inspections and cleaning
    - Software updates and patches
    - Network equipment testing

Service Standards and Monitoring

- Service delivery is monitored through **helpdesk reports and user feedback**.
- Key performance indicators (KPIs) include response time, resolution time, and user satisfaction.
- Continuous improvement is encouraged through regular reviews.

Policy Enforcement and Review

- Misuse of ICT support services may result in disciplinary action.
- This policy is reviewed periodically to align with technological advancements and institutional needs.

Integration of ICT in Teaching, Learning, and Administration Policy

This policy provides a framework for the **effective use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT)** to enhance **instructional delivery, student learning outcomes, and administrative efficiency** within the ICT college.

ICT Integration in Teaching

Digital Teaching Tools

- Trainers are encouraged to use:

    - Learning Management System and E-Library for course content, assignments, and assessments.
    - Multimedia tools (presentations, videos, simulations, virtual labs).
    - Online collaboration tools (forums, email, video conferencing).
- Teaching methods support **blended and online learning** models.

Curriculum Enhancement

- ICT competencies are embedded into curricula across all programs.
- Courses emphasize **hands-on practical skills**, problem-solving, and innovation.
- Continuous review ensures alignment with **industry standards and emerging technologies**.

ICT Integration in Learning

Student Engagement

- Students access learning materials anytime through digital platforms.
- ICT supports **self-paced, collaborative, and student-centered learning** approaches.
- Online assessments and feedback improve learning outcomes.

Digital Literacy

- The institution promotes digital literacy skills such as:
    - Information search and evaluation
    - Ethical ICT use
    - Cybersecurity awareness
- Students are trained to use ICT tools responsibly and professionally.

ICT Integration in Administration

Digital Administrative Systems

- Core administrative processes are digitized, including:
    - Student admissions and registration
    - Examination and grading systems
    - Finance and payroll management
    - Human resource management
- Electronic document management systems improve efficiency and reduce paperwork.

Communication and Decision-Making

- Official communication is conducted through institutional email and portals.
- Data analytics and management systems support **evidence-based decision-making**.
- Automation reduces delays and improves service delivery.

Capacity Building and Support

- Regular training programs are provided for staff and students on:
    - Use of new ICT tools
    - E-learning methodologies
    - Administrative systems
- ICT support services ensure smooth adoption and usage.

Infrastructure and Security

- Adequate ICT infrastructure (networks, labs, servers) supports system integration.
- All ICT systems comply with **cybersecurity and data protection policies**.
- Regular system upgrades ensure reliability and scalability.

Finance and Procurement Policy

This policy provides a framework for the **management of financial resources and procurement activities** within the college. It ensures **transparency, accountability, value for money, and compliance** with relevant financial regulations and institutional objectives.

Financial Management

Budgeting

- The college prepares an **annual budget** aligned with strategic and academic plans.
- Departments submit budget proposals for approval by management.
- Budget allocations prioritize **academic delivery, ICT infrastructure, and student services**.
- Budget reviews are conducted periodically to ensure effective utilization.

Revenue Management

- Revenue sources may include:
    - Tuition and examination fees
    - Grants and donations
    - Consultancy and training services
- All revenues are recorded, receipted, and banked through **either KCB or Cooperative Bank of Kenya.**
- Fee structures are approved by the governing body and communicated transparently.

Expenditure Control

- Expenditure must be authorized according to approved **financial limits and approval hierarchies**.
- Payments are supported by valid documentation (invoices, delivery notes, contracts).
- Segregation of duties is maintained to prevent fraud and mismanagement.

Procurement Policy

Procurement Principles

All procurement activities shall adhere to:

- Transparency and fairness
- Competitive sourcing
- Value for money
- Accountability and integrity

Procurement Process

- Procurement follows approved procedures including:
    - Needs identification and requisition
    - Budget confirmation
    - Supplier sourcing and evaluation
    - Approval and purchase order issuance
    - Delivery, inspection, and acceptance
- Procurement methods include:
    - Open tendering
    - Request for quotations
    - Direct procurement

ICT Procurement

- ICT equipment and software must meet **institutional standards** and technical specifications.
- The ICT department provides **technical input and approval** before purchase.
- Preference is given to:
    - Scalable and compatible technologies
    - Licensed software and secure systems
- Maintenance, warranty, and support considerations are mandatory in ICT procurement.

Asset Management

- All procured assets are:
    - Recorded in an **asset register**
    - Tagged and tracked
- Assets are used strictly for institutional purposes.
- Disposal of assets follows the **asset disposal policy** and relevant laws.

Ethics and Compliance

- Staff involved in finance and procurement must adhere to:
    - Code of conduct and ethics
    - Conflict of interest declarations

- Fraud, bribery, or favoritism is strictly prohibited and subject to disciplinary and legal action.

Audits and Accountability

- Internal and external audits are conducted regularly.
- Audit findings are acted upon promptly to improve controls.
- Financial reports are prepared and presented to management and governing bodies.

Policy Review

- This policy is reviewed periodically to align with:
    - Institutional growth
    - Technological advancements
    - Changes in financial and procurement regulations

CHAPTER 7: FINANCE AND PROCUREMENT POLICY

This chapter outlines the principles, procedures, and controls governing **financial management and procurement** in the ICT College. It ensures **transparency, accountability, value for money, and compliance** with applicable laws and institutional objectives.

Budget Preparation and Approval Process

The budget preparation and approval process ensures that the ICT College's financial resources are **planned, allocated, approved, and utilized responsibly** in line with institutional priorities and strategic goals.

a) Budget Preparation

- Budget preparation is conducted **annually** under the coordination of the **Finance Department**.
- Each department prepares a **detailed budget proposal** outlining expected expenditures and justifications, including:
    - Academic programs and training activities
    - ICT & Accounting infrastructure, software, maintenance and academic resources.
    - Staff remuneration and development
    - Student services and welfare
- Budget proposals are aligned with the **institutional strategic plan**, projected enrollment, and available revenue.

b) Budget Review and Consolidation

- Departmental budgets are reviewed by the **Finance Committee** and senior management for accuracy, feasibility, and compliance.
- Overlapping or non-essential expenditures are adjusted to ensure **cost-effectiveness and priority funding**.
- The reviewed departmental budgets are consolidated into a **draft institutional budget**.

c) Budget Approval

- The consolidated budget is submitted to the **College Management or Governing Board** for approval.
- Approval considers:
    - Available financial resources
    - Institutional priorities and development plans
    - Regulatory and funding requirements
- Once approved, the budget becomes the **official financial guide** for the financial year.

d) Budget Implementation

- Funds are released to departments according to the **approved allocations**.
- All expenditures must remain within approved limits and follow procurement procedures.
- Any budget reallocations or supplementary budgets require **formal approval**.

Financial Record-Keeping and Auditing

This subsection outlines how the ICT College maintains **accurate financial records** and conducts **regular audits** to ensure transparency, accountability, and compliance with financial regulations.

a) Financial Record-Keeping

- The college maintains **complete, accurate, and up-to-date financial records** for all transactions.
- Records include:
    - Receipts and payment vouchers
    - Invoices and delivery notes
    - Bank statements and cashbooks
    - Payroll records.
    - Asset and inventory registers
- Financial records are prepared and stored using **accounting systems** (both manual and computerized).
- All records are supported by **original source documents** and properly authorized.
- Financial records are securely stored and retained for the **statutory period** as required by law.
- Access to financial records is restricted to **authorized finance personnel** to prevent misuse or tampering.

b) Financial Auditing

- The college conducts **regular internal audits** to:
    - Verify accuracy of financial records
    - Ensure compliance with approved budgets and policies
    - Detect errors, fraud, or misuse of funds.
- **External audits** are conducted annually by independent and qualified auditors.
- Auditors have full access to relevant financial records and systems.
- Audit reports are submitted to **management** for review.

c) Audit Follow-Up and Compliance

- Audit findings and recommendations are documented and addressed promptly.
- Management develops and implements **corrective action plans** for identified weaknesses.

- Continuous audit follow-up ensures improved financial controls and accountability.

Procurement Procedures (Tenders, Quotations, and Approvals)

This section outlines the standardized procurement procedures used by the College to ensure **fairness, transparency, accountability, and value for money** in the acquisition of goods, services, and works.

a) Procurement Planning

- All procurement activities are planned in advance and aligned with the **approved annual budget**.
- Departments identify procurement needs and submit **formal requisitions** with clear specifications and justifications.
- The Procurement Unit verifies availability of funds before initiating the process.

b) Procurement Methods

i) Open Tendering

- Used for **high-value or complex procurements**.
- Tenders are publicly advertised to ensure open competition.
- Tender documents clearly outline specifications, evaluation criteria, and submission deadlines.
- An evaluation committee assesses bids based on **technical compliance, price, and vendor capability**.

ii) Request for Quotations (RFQ)

- Applied for **low to medium-value purchases**.
- At least **three competitive quotations** are obtained from qualified suppliers.
- Selection is based on price, quality, delivery time, and supplier reliability.

iii) Direct Procurement

- Used only in exceptional cases, such as:
    - Emergency purchases
    - Single-source or proprietary items
- Requires **written justification and management approval**.

c) Approval Process

- All procurement requests must receive **prior approval** based on delegated authority levels.
- Approvals are required at key stages:
  - Requisition approval
  - Supplier selection approval
  - Purchase order or contract approval
- No procurement may proceed without **budget confirmation and authorization**.

d) Purchase Orders and Contracts

- Approved procurements are formalized through **purchase orders or contracts**.
- Documents specify quantities, prices, delivery timelines, warranties, and payment terms.
- Contracts are signed only by **the manager.**

e) Delivery, Inspection, and Acceptance

- Goods and services are inspected upon delivery to confirm compliance with specifications.
- An inspection and acceptance report is prepared before payment is processed.
- Defective or non-compliant items are rejected or returned.

f) Documentation and Record-Keeping

- All procurement records are properly filed, including:
  - Requisitions
  - Quotations or tender documents
  - Evaluation reports
  - Approval records
  - Delivery and payment documents
- Records are retained for audit and accountability purposes.

Asset Management and Inventory Control

This section outlines how the RURALNET Training College manages, tracks, and safeguards its physical and academic assets to ensure **accountability, optimal utilization, and value for money** throughout the asset lifecycle.

a) Asset Identification and Registration

- All assets acquired by the college are **formally recorded** in an asset and inventory register (available both manually and online through Staff Management system).

- Each asset is assigned a **unique identification number** (referenced in file indexing)**.**
- Asset records include:
    - Asset description and serial number
    - Date of acquisition and cost
    - Location and assigned user/department
    - Current condition and warranty details

b) Asset Custody and Use

- Assets are issued to departments under **custodial responsibility**.
- Assets must be used **strictly for institutional purposes**.
- Users are responsible for safeguarding assets against loss, damage, or misuse.

c) Inventory Control

- Regular **physical stock-taking and verification** is conducted annually.
- Inventory records are reconciled with physical counts to identify discrepancies.
- Losses, damages, or shortages are reported immediately and investigated.
- Obsolete, damaged, or idle assets are flagged for **repair, reallocation, or disposal**.

d) Maintenance and Depreciation

- Assets are maintained through **scheduled servicing and repairs** to extend useful life.
- Depreciation of assets is calculated in accordance with **accepted accounting standards**.
- Maintenance and depreciation records support financial reporting and asset replacement planning.

e) Disposal of Assets

- Disposal of assets follows the approved **Asset Disposal and Decommissioning Policy**.
- Disposed assets are removed from the asset register.

Resource Mobilization (Grants, Donations, and Income-Generating Projects)

This section outlines how Ruralnet Training College seeks, manages, and utilizes **additional financial and material resources** to support institutional sustainability, growth, and innovation beyond tuition revenue.

a) Purpose of Resource Mobilization

- To supplement institutional income and reduce over-reliance on student fees.

- To support development of **ICT infrastructure, research, innovation, and student programs**.
- To enhance institutional sustainability and competitiveness.

b) Grants and External Funding

- The college actively seeks **grants from government agencies, development partners, NGOs, and international organizations**.
- Grant proposals are developed in alignment with:
  - Institutional strategic goals
  - Academic development priorities
- All grant applications require **management approval** before submission.
- Grant funds are:
  - Used strictly for the approved purpose
  - Properly accounted for and reported to donors
- Compliance with donor conditions and reporting timelines is mandatory.

c) Donations and Sponsorships

- The institution may receive **financial or material donations** from individuals, corporations, alumni, or partner organizations.
- All donations must be:
  - Declared and formally acknowledged
  - Recorded in financial and asset registers
- Donations must not compromise the institution's **independence, ethics, or academic integrity**.
- Sponsored projects and facilities are managed transparently and in line with institutional values.

d) Income-Generating Projects

- The college may establish **income-generating activities (IGAs)** such as:
  - Short professional ICT courses and certifications
  - technical support services such as computer repair
  - Software installation
  - Developing websites to interested clients.
  - Designing and printing services.
- IGAs must be:
  - Approved by management
  - Financially viable and legally compliant
- Income generated is:
  - Properly accounted for

- Reinvested into academic programs, infrastructure, and student services

e) Oversight and Accountability

- Resource mobilization activities are overseen by **management and finance committees**.
- Regular financial and performance reports are prepared.
- Audits ensure transparency, compliance, and effective utilization of resources.

CHAPTER 8: QUALITY ASSURANCE AND ACCREDITATION

This chapter outlines the policies and mechanisms used by the ICT College to **maintain high academic standards, ensure continuous improvement, and comply with accreditation requirements** set by relevant regulatory and professional bodies.

Purpose

- To ensure delivery of **quality, relevant, and industry-aligned education and training**.
- To promote a culture of **continuous improvement and accountability**.
- To ensure compliance with **national and international accreditation standards**.
- To enhance the credibility and recognition of the institution's qualifications.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All academic programs and courses.
- Teaching, learning, assessment, and research activities.
- Administrative and support services.
- All staff, students, and institutional processes.

Program Accreditation

Accreditation Requirements

- All academic programs must be **approved and accredited** by the relevant authority before offering them.
- Programs are developed in line with:
    - National qualification frameworks (TVETA and KASNEB)
    - Industry standards and labor market needs (ICT Authority, CSK)
- Accreditation documentation includes curriculum outlines, staffing profiles, facilities, and assessment methods.

Accreditation Review and Renewal

- Accredited programs are reviewed after every five years to maintain relevance and compliance.
- The college prepares and submits **renewal applications** within stipulated timelines 5 years for TVETA and KASNEB.
- Any changes to programs are communicated to accrediting bodies for approval.

Monitoring and Evaluation of Teaching and Learning

- Teaching effectiveness is monitored through:
  - Classroom observations
  - Student evaluations
  - Peer reviews
- Learning outcomes are assessed using performance data, examination results, and graduate feedback.
- Identified gaps are addressed through curriculum review, staff training, or resource enhancement.

Assessment and Examination Quality

- Assessment tools are aligned with **learning outcomes and competency standards**.
- Moderation processes ensure:
  - Fairness and consistency in marking
  - Validity and reliability of assessments
- Examination administration follows strict security and integrity procedures.

Continuous Improvement

- Quality assurance is a **continuous process**, not a one-time activity.
- Action plans are developed based on:
  - Internal reviews
  - External audit reports
  - Stakeholder feedback
- Progress is monitored and documented for accountability.

Documentation and Record-Keeping

- Quality assurance and accreditation records are properly maintained, including:
  - Review reports
  - Accreditation certificates
  - Improvement action plans
- Documentation supports audits, inspections, and institutional learning.

Internal Quality Assurance Committee

The Internal Quality Assurance Committee (IQAC) is responsible for **planning, implementing, monitoring, and improving quality standards** in all academic, administrative, and support services of the ICT College.

a) Composition

The committee is appointed by college management and typically includes:

- Chairperson (Senior academic or administrator)
- Head of Academic Affairs
- Quality Assurance Officer
- Representatives of academic staff
- ICT/Systems representative
- Accounting repetitive
- Student representative

b) Roles and Responsibilities

The Internal Quality Assurance Committee shall:

- Develop and review **quality assurance policies, procedures, and standards**.
- Monitor the **quality of teaching, learning, and assessment** across programs.
- Oversee curriculum implementation and alignment with accreditation requirements.
- Coordinate internal academic audits and self-evaluation exercises.
- Review student, staff, and stakeholder feedback and recommend improvements.
- Ensure compliance with requirements of accrediting and regulatory bodies.
- Prepare quality assurance reports for management and governing bodies.

c) Meetings and Reporting

- The committee meets **regularly** (at least once per term or semester).
- Decisions and action points are documented in **formal minutes**.
- Reports are submitted to college management for review and implementation

d) Continuous Improvement

- The committee develops **quality improvement action plans** based on findings from reviews and audits.
- Progress on action plans is monitored and evaluated periodically.
- Best practices and innovations are promoted across the institution.

Program Accreditation and Review

- All academic programs must be **approved and accredited** by TVET/CDACC and KASNEB before implementation.
- Programs are developed in line with:

    - National qualification frameworks
    - Industry and labor market needs
    - Institutional mission and vision
- Periodic **program reviews** are conducted to:
    - Assess relevance, effectiveness, and outcomes
    - Update curricula to reflect emerging ICT trends
- Any major program changes require **re-approval or notification** to accrediting bodies.
- Accreditation renewal is conducted within stipulated timelines to maintain program recognition.

Staff and Student Evaluation

Staff Evaluation

- Teaching staff are evaluated regularly to ensure **quality instruction and professional competence**.
- Evaluation methods include:
    - Student feedback surveys
    - Peer reviews and classroom observations
    - Performance appraisals
- Evaluation results inform:
    - Staff development and training needs
    - Promotions and rewards
    - Teaching improvement strategies

Student Evaluation

- Student performance is assessed through:
    - Continuous assessment tests (CATs)
    - Practical work and projects
    - Examinations
- Student satisfaction surveys collect feedback on:
    - Teaching quality
    - Learning resources and facilities
    - Support services
- Feedback is used to enhance learning experiences and service delivery.

Institutional Self-Assessment

- The College conducts **periodic self-assessment** to evaluate institutional performance.
- Self-assessment covers Academic programs, Teaching and learning processes, Infrastructure and ICT resources and Governance and administration
- Self-evaluation reports identify Strengths and best practices and Gaps and areas for improvement
- Findings are documented and used for planning, accreditation, and quality enhancement.

CHAPTER 9: HEALTH, SAFETY, AND ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY

This chapter sets out the policies and procedures that ensure a **safe, healthy, and environmentally responsible learning and working environment** within the College. It promotes the well-being of students, staff, visitors, and the surrounding community.

Purpose

- To protect the health and safety of all members of the institution.
- To prevent accidents, injuries, and occupational hazards.
- To promote environmental sustainability and responsible resource use.
- To comply with **occupational health, safety, and environmental regulations**.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All students, staff, visitors, and contractors.
- All college premises, including classrooms, laboratories, offices, hostels, and common areas.
- All institutional activities, including academic, administrative, and extracurricular activities.

Occupational Health and Safety

Health and Safety Responsibilities

- Management provides a safe working and learning environment, including proper facilities and equipment.
- Staff and students must comply with health and safety guidelines and report hazards promptly.

Workplace Safety

- Laboratories and workshops are designed to meet **safety standards**.
- Electrical installations and equipment are regularly inspected and maintained.
- Emergency exits, fire extinguishers, and safety signage are clearly marked and accessible.
- First aid kits are available and regularly replenished.

Health Services and Wellness

- The college provides access to **basic health services**, including first aid and referrals to medical facilities.
- Counseling and mental health support services are available to students.

- Health awareness programs promote wellness, stress management, and healthy lifestyles.

Emergency Preparedness and Response

- Emergency procedures are established for:
  - Fire outbreaks
  - Electrical accidents
  - Medical emergencies
  - Natural disasters
- Regular **fire drills and safety training** are conducted to staff.
- Emergency contact information is displayed prominently across the school.

Environmental Protection and Sustainability

Environmental Management

- The college promotes responsible use of resources such as electricity, water, and paper.
- Waste management systems are in place, including segregation and proper disposal of waste.
- Special attention is given to **electronic waste (e-waste)** management.

Environmental Awareness

- Students and staff are sensitized on environmental conservation and sustainability practices.
- Green ICT practices such as energy-efficient equipment and digital documentation are encouraged.

Compliance and Enforcement

- All activities must comply with **health, safety, and environmental laws and regulations**.
- Non-compliance may result in disciplinary action.
- Regular inspections and audits ensure policy adherence.

Workplace Safety Measures

Workplace safety measures are actions and controls put in place to **prevent accidents, injuries, and health risks** for staff, students, and visitors within the College.

1. Physical Safety Measures

- Clearly marked **emergency exits and evacuation routes** in all buildings.
- Installation and regular servicing of **fire extinguishers**

- Proper lighting in classrooms, laboratories, corridors, and stairways.
- Safe furniture and equipment arrangement to prevent tripping and collisions.

2. Electrical and Equipment Safety

- Regular inspection and maintenance of **electrical wiring, sockets, and power extensions**.
- Use of **electrical protectors (TV/fridge guards)** for ICT equipment.
- Safe handling and storage of computers, servers, and networking devices.
- Only qualified personnel allowed to repair or modify electrical and ICT systems.

3. Laboratory Safety

- Clear lab safety rules displayed in all laboratories.
- No food or drinks allowed near computers and electrical equipment.
- Adequate ventilation and temperature control to prevent overheating.
- Proper cable management to avoid tripping hazards.

4. Health and Ergonomic Safety

- Provision of **ergonomic chairs and adjustable desks** to reduce strain injuries.
- Guidance on correct posture, screen height, and keyboard use.
- Scheduled breaks to reduce eye strain and repetitive stress injuries.
- Use of screen filters where necessary.

5. Fire and Emergency Safety

- Regular **fire drills and emergency response training**.
- Availability of trained first-aid personnel on campus.
- Clearly displayed emergency contact numbers.
- Accessible and well-stocked **first aid kits** in key locations.

6. Chemical and Environmental Safety

- Safe storage and labeling of cleaning chemicals and lab materials.
- Proper disposal of hazardous waste, including **e-waste** (old computers, batteries).
- Clean and hygienic learning and working environments.

7. Security and Access Control

- Controlled access to ICT labs, server rooms, and sensitive areas.
- Use of ID cards, locks, or biometric systems where applicable.
- Surveillance systems (CCTV) in strategic locations to enhance safety.

8. Training and Awareness

- Safety orientation for new staff and students.
- Regular safety awareness programs and updates.
- Clear reporting procedures for hazards, accidents, and near-misses.

Health and Sanitation Standards

- The College maintains **clean, hygienic, and safe facilities** for all users.
- Classrooms, laboratories, offices, washrooms, and common areas are **cleaned and disinfected daily**.
- Adequate **sanitation facilities** (toilets, hand-washing stations, clean water) are provided and maintained.

Waste Management (E-Waste)

- The college shall implement a **proper waste management system**, including waste segregation (paper, plastics, organic waste).
- **Electronic waste (e-waste)** such as obsolete computers, printers, batteries, and cables shall be handled separately.
- E-waste are:
    - Safely stored in designated areas
    - Disposed of through **licensed recyclers or approved disposal agencies**
- Environmentally friendly practices such as **reuse, recycling, and reduction** of waste shall be encouraged.
- Disposal practices shall comply with **environmental protection laws and regulations**.

CHAPTER 10: COMMUNICATION AND PUBLIC RELATIONS POLICY

This chapter defines how the College manages **internal and external communication** to ensure accurate information flow, transparency, and a positive institutional image.

Purpose

- To promote **effective, timely, and clear communication** within the college.
- To enhance the institution's **public image and reputation**.
- To ensure consistent and accurate dissemination of information to stakeholders.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- All staff, students, management, and board members.
- All official communication channels and platforms.
- All internal and external stakeholders, including parents, partners, regulators, and the public.

Official Communication Channels

Official communication channels are approved platforms used to share **accurate, authorized, and consistent information** within and outside the College.

Internal Official Communication Channels

- **Institutional Email System** – Used for official notices, academic communication, and administrative instructions.
- **Whatsapp group / Student Portal** – For academic announcements, timetables, assignments, and results.
- **Notice Boards** – Display official notices for students and staff.
- **Staff and Student Meetings** – Used to communicate policies, decisions, and important updates.
- **Memos and Circulars** – Issued by management for formal internal communication.

External Official Communication Channels

- **Official College Website** – Primary platform for public information, admissions, programs, and announcements.
- **Official Social Media Accounts** – Used for publicity, announcements, and engagement with the public.
- **Press Releases and Media Statements** – Issued through authorized spokespersons only.

- **Official Letters and Emails** – Used for communication with government agencies, partners, and stakeholders.

Authorization and Control

- Only **staff** may issue official communication on behalf of the college.
- All communication must be **accurate, professional, and consistent** with institutional policies.
- Unauthorized communication representing the institution is prohibited.

Public Relations and Branding Policy

This policy establishes guidelines for managing the ICT College's public image, institutional identity, and relationships with stakeholders. It ensures that the college maintains a professional reputation, consistent brand identity, and positive relationships with students, parents, staff, industry partners, government agencies, and the general public.

Institutional Branding

The college shall maintain a consistent visual and professional identity in all its official materials.

- Logo: The official college logo shall be used consistently on letters, certificates, posters, brochures, websites, and other institutional materials.
- Institutional colors: Approved colors (green, black, white), fonts, and design styles shall be used across official communication materials.
- Slogan and motto (***Bridging digital divide between rural and urban areas***): The approved institutional motto and slogan shall reflect the college's mission, vision, and values.
- Uniformity: Business cards, staff identification cards, certificates, admission letters, and other official documents shall follow approved branding standards.
- Brand protection: Unauthorized alteration, misuse, or reproduction of the college logo and other official branding elements shall be prohibited.

Advertising and Promotional Activities

The college shall undertake ethical and professional marketing activities to promote its courses, services, achievements, and opportunities.

Permitted promotional activities include:

- Designing and distributing posters, flyers, brochures, and banners.
- Advertising courses through radio and other media.

- Promoting courses through social media platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, and WhatsApp.
- Maintaining an updated official website containing accurate information about courses, fees, admission requirements, and contacts.
- Organizing open days, exhibitions, career fairs, and community outreach activities.
- Developing partnerships with schools, businesses, industries, and community organizations.

All advertisements must be truthful and must not make misleading claims about accreditation, qualifications, employment opportunities, or course outcomes.

Media Relations and Public Representation

- Only authorized officers shall issue official statements or represent the college to the media.
- Media inquiries shall be directed to the designated Public Relations Officer or authorized spokesperson.
- Press releases and public statements must be accurate, professional, and approved before publication.
- Staff must not disclose confidential institutional information without authorization.
- The college shall maintain constructive relationships with media organizations and other relevant stakeholders.

Digital Presence and Social Media Management

- The college shall maintain official digital platforms to share announcements, advertise courses, and engage with stakeholders.
- Official accounts shall be managed by authorized personnel.
- Social media posts must be professional, accurate, respectful, and consistent with the institution's values.
- Photographs, videos, testimonials, and personal information of students or staff shall be published only with appropriate authorization and consent where required.
- Complaints and inquiries received through digital platforms shall be handled promptly and professionally.
- Official account passwords shall be secured and updated when necessary, particularly when account administrators change.

Stakeholder Relations and Community Engagement

The college shall promote positive relationships with its stakeholders through:

- Regular communication with students, parents, and guardians where appropriate.
- Collaboration with employers and industry professionals.
- Participation in community development and digital literacy initiatives.
- Establishment of partnerships with government agencies, NGOs, businesses, and other educational institutions.

- Collection and consideration of stakeholder feedback to improve institutional services.

Complaints and Reputation Management

- The college shall establish procedures for receiving and responding to public complaints.
- Complaints shall be acknowledged, investigated, and resolved fairly.
- False information about the institution shall be addressed using factual, professional, and appropriate communication.
- During crises, only authorized spokespersons shall issue official statements.
- Lessons from complaints and reputational incidents shall inform improvements in communication and service delivery.

Roles and Responsibilities

Responsible office/person	Key responsibility
College Management	Approves branding standards and major publicity campaigns.
Public Relations Officer	Coordinates publicity, media relations, and stakeholder engagement.
ICT and Accounting Department	Maintains the college website, digital platforms, and technical security.
Heads of Departments	Verify the accuracy of information about their courses and services.
All Staff	Protect the college's reputation and follow communication guidelines.

Digital and Social Media Use

- Official social media accounts shall be managed responsibly and professionally.
- Staff and students must avoid posting content that may damage the institution’s image.
- Online communication shall comply with **data protection and privacy laws**.

CHAPTER 11: LIBRARY AND LEARNING RESOURCE POLICY

11.1 Introduction

The Library and Learning Resource Policy establishes the guidelines for the administration, acquisition, organization, access, use, preservation, and management of library materials and other learning resources within the College. It is intended to support effective teaching, learning, research, practical training, innovation, and independent study among students and staff in both ICT and Accounting programmes.

The College recognizes the library as an essential academic support facility that provides access to textbooks, reference materials, journals, digital resources, software documentation, accounting publications, ICT manuals, research materials, and other educational resources required for quality training.

The policy promotes equitable access to information, responsible use of learning materials, academic integrity, respect for intellectual property, and the continuous improvement of library services.

11.2 Purpose of the Policy

The objectives of this policy are to:

1. Establish a clear framework for the administration and management of the College library.
2. Ensure the availability of relevant, current, and adequate learning resources for ICT and Accounting programmes.
3. Define the procedures for borrowing, returning, renewing, and reserving library materials.
4. Promote the effective use of digital libraries, e-learning platforms, and electronic learning resources.
5. Protect copyrighted materials and promote responsible information use in accordance with applicable copyright laws.
6. Encourage reading, research, independent learning, innovation, and professional development.
7. Ensure the security, proper maintenance, and accountability of library resources.
8. Provide fair and accessible library services to all eligible students and staff.
9. Establish procedures for monitoring, evaluating, and improving library services.

11.3 Scope of Application

This policy applies to:

- All registered students undertaking ICT, Accounting, and other approved College programmes.

- Lecturers, trainers, instructors, administrative staff, and management.
- The librarian and other personnel assigned library-related duties.
- Users of the College's physical library, digital library, e-learning platforms, and other approved learning resource facilities.
- All physical and electronic learning materials acquired, subscribed to, licensed, or otherwise made available by the College.

The policy applies to resources used for classroom instruction, practical sessions, assignments, examinations, research, projects, and professional development.

11.4 Library Administration and Staffing

11.4.1 Library Management

The College shall establish and maintain a library or designated learning resource centre appropriate to its programmes, student population, and available resources.

The library shall operate under the overall supervision of College management and shall be managed by a designated librarian or an appropriately assigned staff member.

The College shall ensure that library operations are conducted in an organized, professional, secure, and learner-friendly environment.

11.4.2 Roles and Responsibilities of the Librarian

The librarian or designated library officer shall be responsible for:

1. Managing daily library operations and ensuring that library services are available during approved operating hours.
2. Acquiring, receiving, cataloguing, classifying, arranging, and maintaining library materials.
3. Maintaining accurate records of library resources, borrowers, returns, reservations, losses, and damaged materials.
4. Assisting students and staff in locating books, journals, research materials, and electronic resources.
5. Orienting new students and staff on library rules, procedures, and available services.
6. Monitoring the condition of books, computers, furniture, and other library equipment.
7. Enforcing borrowing, return, access, and acceptable-use rules fairly and consistently.
8. Preparing periodic reports on library usage, resource availability, damaged materials, and emerging learning needs.
9. Recommending new acquisitions, replacements, subscriptions, and improvements to library services.
10. Promoting reading culture, information literacy, research skills, and responsible use of information.

Where a qualified librarian is not available, management shall assign a competent staff member to oversee library services and arrange appropriate training where necessary.

11.4.3 Responsibilities of College Management in library services

College management shall:

- Approve library budgets and acquisition plans.
- Provide suitable library space, furniture, shelving, lighting, and learning facilities.
- Support the recruitment or designation of competent library personnel.
- Ensure the availability of resources relevant to ICT and Accounting programmes.
- Approve library operating hours, borrowing limits, and other administrative procedures.
- Monitor compliance with this policy and provide resources for continuous improvement.

11.4.4 Responsibilities of Heads of Departments and Lecturers

Heads of departments and lecturers shall identify learning-resource needs arising from approved curricula, course outlines, assignments, practical lessons, and examinations.

They shall recommend suitable textbooks, reference materials, software manuals, accounting standards, technical publications, and other relevant resources. They shall also encourage students to use library resources appropriately and report outdated or inadequate materials to the librarian.

11.4.5 Responsibilities of Students and Other Users

All library users shall:

1. Observe library rules and approved operating hours.
2. Handle books, computers, furniture, and other resources with care.
3. Return borrowed materials by the specified deadlines.
4. Maintain a quiet and respectful learning environment.
5. Avoid unauthorized removal, alteration, damage, or destruction of library property.
6. Respect the rights of other users to access available resources.
7. Comply with copyright, licensing, privacy, and academic integrity requirements.

11.5 Acquisition and Management of Learning Resources

11.5.1 Identification and Acquisition

The College shall acquire learning resources based on curriculum requirements, enrolment levels, lecturer recommendations, student needs, technological developments, and available funding.

Priority shall be given to materials that are relevant, reliable, current, and appropriate to the qualifications and training programmes offered by the College.

For ICT programmes, resources include:

- Computer applications and programming textbooks.

- Web development, networking, cybersecurity, and database management manuals.
- Computer hardware, software installation, and troubleshooting guides.
- Data analysis, digital design, and information systems publications.
- Software documentation and authorized technical learning materials.

For Accounting programmes, resources include:

- Financial accounting and management accounting textbooks.
- Bookkeeping, taxation, auditing, and financial management materials.
- Computerized accounting and accounting information systems manuals.
- Business mathematics, economics, and entrepreneurship publications.
- Relevant accounting standards, tax guidance, and professional reference materials.

The College shall periodically review its collection to ensure that resources remain relevant to current curricula, industry practices, and applicable professional requirements.

11.5.2 Registration and Cataloguing

All acquired library resources shall be recorded in the library inventory or approved library management system.

Records should include, where applicable:

- Title and author.
- Publisher and publication date.
- Edition or version.
- Accession or identification number.
- Date of acquisition.
- Purchase price or acquisition source.
- Resource category and location.
- Current condition and availability status.

Resources shall be classified and arranged in a manner that enables users to identify and retrieve them efficiently.

11.5.3 Stocktaking and Resource Maintenance

The College shall conduct periodic stocktaking to verify the existence, condition, and location of library resources.

Damaged, obsolete, duplicated, or irrelevant materials may be repaired, replaced, archived, or withdrawn

Disposal of library assets shall be documented and approved by the management. Electronic resources and licensed materials shall be handled in accordance with applicable licence conditions.

11.6 Library Access and Operating Rules

11.6.1 Access to the Library

Library access shall be available to eligible students and staff in accordance with the College's approved operating hours and access procedures.

Users may be required to present a valid student or staff identification document or provide other approved identification before accessing borrowing services.

Access to restricted collections, staff-only areas, examination materials, and licensed electronic resources shall be controlled by the authorized personnel.

11.6.2 Opening Hours

The library shall be opened at 8am and remaining running up to 6pm.

Operating hours may be adjusted during examinations, holidays, practical training periods, or other academic activities. Any changes shall be communicated through official College channels.

11.6.3 Conduct Within the Library

Users shall:

- Maintain silence or observe designated quiet-study arrangements.
- Keep the library clean and orderly.
- Switch mobile devices to silent mode where appropriate.
- Avoid eating, drinking, or engaging in activities that may damage resources, subject to designated arrangements.
- Refrain from disturbing, harassing, or intimidating other users.
- Use library computers and internet facilities for authorized educational and research purposes.
- Follow instructions issued by authorized library personnel.

The College may restrict access to users who repeatedly violate library rules, subject to applicable disciplinary procedures.

11.7 Borrowing, Renewal, and Return of Library Materials

11.7.1 Eligibility to Borrow

Registered students and authorized staff may borrow materials in accordance with the borrowing procedures established by the College.

Borrowing privileges may depend on the user's registration status, the category of material, and whether the user has overdue or unreturned resources.

Reference books, rare materials, reserved textbooks, examination papers, and other restricted resources may be designated for library use only.

11.7.2 Borrowing Procedures

Every loan shall be recorded in the library register or electronic library management system.

The record shall indicate the borrower's identity, the resource borrowed, the date of issue, the due date, and any other information required for accountability.

Borrowers shall verify that materials are in acceptable condition before leaving the library and report any existing damage to the librarian.

The College shall establish and communicate borrowing limits and loan periods for students and staff. These limits may vary according to the type of material and the level of demand.

11.7.3 Renewal of Borrowed Materials

Borrowed materials may be renewed where the College permits renewal and no reservation or other restriction prevents it.

Renewal shall be requested before the due date. The librarian may decline a renewal where the material is urgently required by another user, the borrower has outstanding obligations, or the item is restricted from renewal.

11.7.4 Return of Materials

Borrowed materials shall be returned on or before the stated due date.

The librarian shall update the borrowing record upon receipt of returned materials and inspect them for damage or missing components.

Users shall not leave returned materials unattended in locations that may cause loss, damage, or failure to record the return.

The library management system shall indicate due days for borrowers, and the librarian shall notify them through sms

11.7.5 Overdue Materials

The College shall establish a procedure for notifying borrowers about overdue materials.

Where approved by management, overdue charges or other proportionate administrative measures may apply. Any applicable charges, calculation method, exemptions, and payment procedures shall be communicated to users before enforcement.

Overdue records shall be maintained accurately, and users shall be given an opportunity to clarify disputed borrowing or return records.

11.7.6 Lost or Damaged Materials

A borrower who loses or damages a library resource shall report the incident promptly to the librarian.

Depending on the circumstances and approved institutional procedures, the College may require the borrower to:

- Replace the resource with an equivalent approved edition or item.
- Pay the approved replacement cost.
- Meet reasonable repair costs where repair is possible.
- Provide a written explanation where the loss or damage resulted from exceptional circumstances.

The College shall assess cases fairly and consider evidence, the condition of the material, and the circumstances of the incident. Any charges shall be documented and communicated to the affected user.

11.7.7 Reservations and Recalls

Where a resource is in high demand, users may reserve it through the approved library procedure.

The College may recall a borrowed resource when it is urgently required for teaching, examinations, research, or other legitimate academic purposes. The borrower shall be informed of the recall and given a reasonable return deadline.

11.7.8 Clearance

Students and staff leaving the College or completing their engagement may be required to obtain library clearance.

Clearance shall confirm that borrowed resources have been returned and that outstanding library obligations have been resolved or formally addressed.

11.8 Digital Library and E-Learning Resources

11.8.1 Provision of Digital Resources

The College shall promote access to appropriate digital learning resources to complement physical library materials and classroom instruction.

Such resources may include:

- Electronic books and academic journals.
- Digital notes, lecture materials, and approved course documents.
- Online research databases and open educational resources.
- E-learning platforms and learning management systems.
- Authorized software manuals, technical documentation, and tutorials.
- Accounting reference materials, tax guidance, and computerized accounting learning resources.
- Programming environments, ICT learning platforms, and technical training materials.

The College may provide access through its website, student portal, learning management system, institutional computers, or other approved digital platforms.

11.8.2 Access and Authentication

Access to digital resources shall be granted according to the applicable institutional procedures and the terms of the relevant service or licence.

Users shall protect their login credentials and shall not share accounts, passwords, access tokens, or restricted materials with unauthorized persons.

The College may suspend or restrict access where necessary to protect systems, enforce licence conditions, investigate suspected misuse, or maintain the security of its digital services.

11.8.3 Acceptable Use of Digital Resources

Digital resources shall be used primarily for learning, teaching, research, assessment, and other authorized institutional activities.

Users shall not:

1. Attempt unauthorized access to library databases, institutional systems, or restricted learning materials.
2. Download, reproduce, or distribute electronic materials in violation of copyright or licence conditions.
3. Use library computers or networks for illegal activities or activities that compromise system security.
4. Upload malicious software or interfere with digital library services.
5. Share restricted examination materials or confidential institutional documents without authorization.
6. Use digital resources to harass others, distribute harmful content, or violate applicable law.

The College may monitor system usage to the extent necessary for security, service administration, compliance, and investigation, subject to applicable privacy and data-protection requirements.

11.8.4 E-Learning Support

The College shall provide reasonable guidance to students and staff on accessing and using approved e-learning platforms and digital learning materials.

Where resources permit, support may include orientation sessions, user guides, practical demonstrations, and assistance with login or access difficulties.

Lecturers shall guide students on how to locate credible sources, evaluate online information, cite digital materials, and use electronic resources effectively in academic work.

11.8.5 Availability and Continuity

The College shall take reasonable measures to maintain the availability, security, and integrity of digital learning resources.

The College shall provide for backups, software updates, access controls, licence renewals, and alternative access arrangements during service interruptions.

Users shall be informed of significant service disruptions and alternative arrangements where these affect teaching, learning, or assessment.

11.9 Copyright and Fair Use Policy

11.9.1 Purpose

The College shall respect copyright, intellectual property rights, software licences, database access conditions, and other legal protections governing learning materials.

This section aims to ensure that students, lecturers, library personnel, and other users access, reproduce, distribute, and use educational materials lawfully and ethically.

All users shall comply with applicable Kenyan copyright legislation, including the Copyright Act, 2001, as amended, and any other relevant legal requirements.

11.9.2 Permitted Educational Use

Educational use of copyrighted material shall be permitted only to the extent allowed by applicable law, licence terms, or authorization from the rights holder.

Depending on the circumstances, permitted activities may include:

- Quoting limited portions of published works for criticism, review, explanation, or academic discussion.
- Citing and referencing sources in assignments, reports, projects, and research.
- Using openly licensed materials in accordance with their stated conditions.

- Accessing and using subscribed electronic resources within the limits of the relevant licence.
- Making copies where expressly authorized or where a legal exception applies.

Educational purpose alone does not automatically make copying or distribution lawful. Users must consider the nature and amount of material used, the purpose of the use, the applicable legal exceptions, and any licence restrictions.

11.9.3 Reproduction and Distribution

Users shall not, without a lawful basis or appropriate authorization:

1. Photocopy or scan entire books, substantial portions of copyrighted publications, or complete course materials for unauthorized distribution.
2. Upload copyrighted textbooks, journal articles, software, or paid learning resources to public websites or unauthorized online groups.
3. Distribute copies of licensed materials beyond the permissions granted to the College.
4. Remove copyright notices, digital rights management protections, or licence information unlawfully.
5. Reproduce, sell, or commercially distribute learning materials without the required authorization.
6. Use copyrighted images, videos, music, software, or other creative works in projects or promotional materials without an appropriate legal basis.

Where copying is necessary for teaching or research, the responsible lecturer or staff member shall ensure that the proposed use complies with applicable law and the relevant licence.

11.9.4 Software Licensing

All software installed on College-owned computers or made available through College systems shall be properly licensed, lawfully obtained, or otherwise authorized for the intended use.

The ICT department or designated officer shall maintain records of software licences, subscriptions, renewals, and permitted installations where applicable.

Students and staff shall not install pirated software, share unauthorized licence keys, bypass licensing controls, or use institutional software beyond the permissions granted.

Software used in ICT and Accounting training shall be selected and managed with due regard to licensing requirements, security, educational suitability, and cost.

11.9.5 Open Educational Resources

The College may encourage the use and creation of open educational resources, including materials released under recognized open licences.

Users shall comply with the conditions of the applicable licence, which may require attribution, prohibit commercial use, require derivative works to be shared under similar terms, or restrict modifications.

The College shall encourage staff and students to acknowledge authors, publishers, creators, and other rights holders whenever required.

11.9.6 Plagiarism and Academic Integrity

All students and staff shall acknowledge the sources of ideas, quotations, data, images, code, tables, and other materials used in their academic or professional work.

Presenting another person's work as one's own, copying without proper acknowledgment, or submitting unauthorized reproductions may constitute plagiarism or academic misconduct.

The College shall address suspected violations in accordance with its Academic Integrity Policy, assessment regulations, and disciplinary procedures.

11.9.7 Responsibilities of the College

The College shall:

- Provide reasonable guidance on copyright compliance and responsible use of learning resources.
- Acquire learning materials through lawful channels.
- Maintain appropriate records of licences and subscriptions.
- Encourage proper referencing and acknowledgment of sources.
- Respond appropriately to credible reports of copyright infringement.
- Remove or restrict access to materials where necessary to address substantiated infringement or legal obligations.
- Review copyright procedures when relevant laws, licences, or institutional practices change.

11.9.8 Reporting Copyright Concerns

Any user who becomes aware of suspected unauthorized copying, distribution, or use of copyrighted materials shall report the concern to the librarian, relevant head of department, ICT officer, or College management.

The College shall review reported concerns fairly and take appropriate corrective action where a violation is established.

11.10 Accessibility and Equal Access to Learning Resources

The College shall strive to provide fair access to library services and learning resources for eligible users.

Where reasonably practicable, the College shall consider the needs of users with disabilities, users who require alternative formats, and students who face barriers accessing digital resources.

Measures may include accessible electronic documents, suitable seating arrangements, clear signage, reasonable assistance from library personnel, and alternative access arrangements where available.

Access restrictions shall be based on legitimate operational, security, licensing, or academic requirements and shall be applied consistently.

11.11 Library Security and Protection of Resources

The College shall establish appropriate measures to protect library materials, equipment, digital records, and user information.

These measures include:

- Maintaining an updated inventory of library assets.
- Controlling access to restricted areas and high-value materials.
- Keeping accurate borrowing and return records.
- Securing computers and other electronic equipment.
- Protecting library databases and digital accounts against unauthorized access.
- Reporting missing resources, suspected theft, or damage promptly.
- Maintaining appropriate backup records for electronic library systems.
- Handling users' personal information in accordance with applicable data-protection requirements.

Any suspected theft, deliberate damage, unauthorized removal, or misuse of library resources shall be reported and handled through the College's established administrative or disciplinary procedures.

11.12 Library Fees, Fines, and Administrative Charges

Any library fines, replacement charges, overdue fees, or other administrative charges shall be available in the system and the library borrowing consent form. Ruralnet Training College shall maintain records of charges assessed, payments received, exemptions granted, and outstanding obligations.

No unauthorized person shall collect library-related payments on behalf of the College. All payments shall follow the approved financial procedures and be supported by the appropriate receipts or records.

The College may review its charges periodically to ensure that they remain reasonable, transparent, and consistent with institutional objectives.

11.15 Roles and Responsibilities Summary

Office or Group	Key Responsibilities
College Management	Policy approval, budgeting, staffing, oversight, and enforcement
Librarian/Library Officer	Daily administration, cataloguing, borrowing records, user support, and reporting
Heads of Departments	Identifying programme-specific learning needs and recommending resources
Lecturers and Trainers	Guiding students in research, referencing, and responsible resource use
ICT Department/Designated ICT Officer	Supporting digital library systems, access controls, security, and technical maintenance
Students	Responsible use, timely return, proper citation, and protection of resources
All Staff	Compliance with library rules, copyright requirements, and institutional procedures

CHAPTER 12: RESEARCH, INNOVATION, AND INDUSTRY LINKAGES POLICY

12.1 Introduction

RuralNet Training College recognizes research, innovation, creativity, and collaboration with industry as essential components of quality technical and vocational education. The College is committed to promoting practical problem-solving, entrepreneurship, applied research, technological advancement, and the development of professional skills that respond to the needs of employers, businesses, government institutions, and the wider community.

The College shall encourage students, lecturers, trainers, and other staff members to undertake research and innovation projects that address real-world challenges, improve service delivery, create employment opportunities, and contribute to social and economic development.

Through partnerships with ICT companies, accounting firms, universities, government agencies, businesses, and other relevant organizations, the College shall seek to strengthen practical training, facilitate knowledge exchange, support student innovation, and improve graduates' readiness for employment and self-employment.

12.2 Purpose of the Policy

The objectives of this policy are to:

1. Establish a framework for planning, conducting, supervising, and evaluating research projects within the College.
2. Promote innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship, and the development of practical solutions to real-world problems.
3. Protect intellectual property generated by students, lecturers, staff members, and the College.
4. Encourage collaboration with ICT firms, accounting firms, universities, research institutions, government bodies, and other industry partners.
5. Provide opportunities for students to gain workplace experience through internships, industrial attachment, mentorship, and job placement programmes.
6. Strengthen the relationship between academic training and labour-market requirements.
7. Encourage the development of commercially viable projects, digital products, business solutions, and other innovations.
8. Promote ethical research practices, responsible data handling, and respect for the rights of research participants.
9. Support graduate employability, entrepreneurship, and sustainable institutional growth.
10. Establish mechanisms for monitoring and evaluating research, innovation, and industry engagement activities.

12.3 Scope of Application

This policy applies to:

- All students undertaking ICT, Accounting, and other approved programmes at RuralNet Training College.
- Lecturers, trainers, supervisors, administrative staff, and management.
- Student projects, institutional research, innovation activities, and approved collaborative research.
- Research and innovation undertaken independently or in partnership with external organizations where the College has an agreed role.
- Internships, industrial attachments, workplace learning, mentorship, career development, and job placement initiatives coordinated by the College.
- Intellectual property, inventions, software, research findings, business models, publications, and other outputs developed through College-supported activities.

All activities covered by this policy shall comply with applicable laws, institutional regulations, professional requirements, and any relevant agreements with external partners.

12.4 Research Project Management

12.4.1 Identification of Research Areas

The College shall encourage research projects that address practical, educational, technological, financial, business, and community development challenges.

Research topics should be relevant to the programmes offered and, where possible, aligned with industry needs and local development priorities.

For ICT programmes, research areas include:

- Website and software application development.
- Database management and information systems.
- Data analysis and business intelligence.
- Computer networking and cybersecurity.
- Artificial intelligence and emerging technologies.
- Digital marketing, graphic design, and multimedia production.
- Computer hardware maintenance and ICT service delivery.
- Digital inclusion and technology adoption in rural communities.

For Accounting programmes, research areas may include:

- Bookkeeping and financial record management.
- Computerized accounting systems.
- Financial management and budgeting.
- Tax compliance and accounting practices among small businesses.
- Internal controls, auditing, and fraud prevention.

- Business performance and financial decision-making.
- Entrepreneurship, savings, and financial literacy.
- Digital transformation in accounting and financial services.

The College may revise or expand these research areas according to curriculum changes, available expertise, industry developments, and emerging community needs.

12.4.2 Proposal Development and Approval

Students and staff undertaking formal research projects shall prepare proposals appropriate to the scope and complexity of their work.

Where applicable, a proposal should include:

1. Project title and background.
2. Statement of the problem.
3. Research objectives and questions.
4. Justification and expected benefits.
5. Brief review of relevant literature or existing solutions.
6. Proposed methodology and implementation plan.
7. Required resources and estimated budget.
8. Project timeline and milestones.
9. Ethical considerations and data-protection measures.
10. Expected outputs, limitations, and evaluation criteria.

Student projects shall be reviewed and approved by the assigned supervisor, department, or authorized academic office before implementation. Research involving external partners, sensitive information, human participants, or significant institutional resources may require additional approval.

12.4.3 Project Supervision

The College shall assign suitable lecturers, trainers, or other qualified persons to supervise approved student research and innovation projects.

Supervisors shall guide students in defining project objectives, selecting appropriate methods, managing time, documenting progress, solving technical or financial problems, and presenting their findings.

Supervisors shall also promote academic integrity, originality, responsible use of resources, and compliance with project requirements.

Students shall remain responsible for their own work and shall provide regular progress updates as required.

12.4.4 Project Implementation and Monitoring

Approved projects shall be implemented according to the agreed objectives, schedule, budget, and applicable safety and ethical requirements.

Project teams shall maintain appropriate records, which may include research notes, source references, code repositories, financial records, test results, survey instruments, meeting notes, and progress reports.

Where significant changes to a project's objectives, methodology, budget, ownership, or external commitments are required, the project team shall seek approval from the relevant supervisor or authorized office.

The College may suspend or terminate a project where there is substantial non-compliance, serious misconduct, misuse of resources, or a significant risk to participants, systems, or institutional interests.

12.4.5 Assessment and Presentation of Findings

Research and innovation projects shall be evaluated using criteria appropriate to the programme and project type.

Assessment may consider:

- Understanding of the problem and project objectives.
- Quality of research, analysis, or technical design.
- Practical functionality and reliability of the proposed solution.
- Accuracy of data and interpretation of findings.
- Originality and evidence of independent work.
- Appropriate documentation, referencing, and reporting.
- Compliance with ethical and professional requirements.
- Presentation, demonstration, and response to questions.

Where appropriate, students may present their work through project demonstrations, exhibitions, research presentations, innovation days, or approved competitions.

12.4.6 Research Records and Reporting

The College shall maintain suitable records of approved institutional research, student projects, completed innovations, publications, and collaborative activities.

Records may include project titles, participants, supervisors, approvals, completion reports, outcomes, partner organizations, and relevant intellectual-property arrangements.

Access to confidential research information shall be restricted to authorized persons, subject to applicable legal requirements and approved agreements.

12.5 Research Ethics and Integrity

12.5.1 Ethical Conduct

All research and innovation activities shall be conducted honestly, responsibly, and professionally.

Researchers shall not fabricate or falsify data, plagiarize the work of others, manipulate findings dishonestly, or misrepresent their contributions.

Research involving people, personal information, confidential business records, or other sensitive data shall be conducted only after obtaining the necessary permissions and safeguards.

Where the nature of a project requires specialist ethical review or external authorization, the College shall ensure that the relevant approval is obtained before the activity begins.

12.5.2 Informed Consent and Confidentiality

Where research involves interviews, questionnaires, observations, or the collection of personal information, participants shall receive appropriate information about the purpose of the study and how their information will be used.

Consent shall be obtained where required by law, ethical standards, or the nature of the activity.

Researchers shall avoid collecting unnecessary personal information and shall protect records against unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, or loss.

For accounting projects involving business records, researchers shall obtain the necessary authorization before accessing financial statements, customer information, payroll records, tax documents, or other confidential business information.

For ICT projects involving databases, websites, networks, or computer systems, researchers shall obtain authorization before accessing, testing, modifying, or scanning systems that they do not own or administer.

12.5.3 Research Misconduct

Suspected research misconduct shall be reported to the relevant head of department, supervisor, or College management.

The College shall review reported cases fairly and confidentially, allowing the affected individuals an appropriate opportunity to respond.

Where misconduct is established, appropriate corrective or disciplinary measures shall be applied in accordance with institutional procedures and applicable law.

12.6 Innovation and Entrepreneurship Support

12.6.1 Promotion of Innovation

The College shall promote innovation by encouraging students and staff to develop practical solutions to problems experienced by individuals, businesses, public institutions, and communities.

Innovation activities include:

- Developing websites, mobile applications, and business management systems.
- Creating accounting tools, financial reporting templates, and bookkeeping solutions.
- Designing data analysis dashboards and decision-support systems.
- Developing digital marketing materials and multimedia products.
- Improving computer repair, networking, and technical support services.
- Developing business plans and technology-enabled enterprises.
- Creating digital solutions for education, agriculture, financial services, and community development.

The College may organize innovation challenges, project exhibitions, entrepreneurship workshops, hackathons, mentorship sessions, and competitions to showcase promising ideas.

12.6.2 Innovation Support Services

Subject to available resources, the College may support innovation through:

1. Technical guidance from lecturers and industry professionals.
2. Access to approved computer laboratories, software, and equipment.
3. Mentorship in business development, project management, and product design.
4. Guidance on market research, customer needs, and product testing.
5. Assistance with preparing project proposals and business plans.
6. Opportunities to demonstrate innovations to potential clients, investors, or partners.
7. Guidance on intellectual property, licensing, commercialization, and business registration.

Access to these services shall be subject to institutional capacity, approved budgets, safety requirements, and applicable agreements.

12.6.3 Entrepreneurship and Commercialization

The College may encourage students and staff to develop viable business opportunities from their research and innovations.

Commercialization may involve licensing a product, offering a service, creating a business, entering into a development partnership, or transferring technology to an interested organization.

Any commercialization activity that uses College resources, confidential information, institutional branding, or jointly developed intellectual property shall comply with the applicable approval procedures and agreements.

The College shall not guarantee that every project will receive funding, become commercially successful, or result in employment.

12.7 Patents, Intellectual Property, and Ownership

12.7.1 Intellectual Property Protection

The College recognizes the importance of protecting intellectual property arising from research, teaching, innovation, and industry collaboration.

Intellectual property may include:

- Software applications, source code, and digital platforms.
- Websites, databases, technical designs, and system architectures.
- Research reports, publications, training materials, and original written works.
- Graphic designs, photographs, illustrations, videos, and multimedia productions.
- Inventions, technical processes, prototypes, and patentable innovations.
- Business models, documented methods, and other protectable creative outputs.

Protection and ownership shall depend on the nature of the work, applicable law, the circumstances of creation, and any relevant agreements.

12.7.2 Ownership of Student Work

Students shall generally retain rights in work they independently create, subject to applicable law, third-party rights, licence terms, and any valid written agreement entered into before or during the project.

Where a project is jointly developed with the College, an external partner, or another student, ownership and permitted use shall be clarified in writing as early as practicable.

A student's use of College facilities or supervision does not, by itself, determine ownership in every case. Any claim to ownership or commercial rights shall be based on the relevant legal and contractual circumstances.

12.7.3 Ownership of Staff and Institutionally Supported Work

Ownership of work developed by staff members shall be determined in accordance with applicable intellectual-property law, employment arrangements, institutional policies, funding conditions, and any relevant written agreements.

Where the College commissions work, provides substantial project funding, or enters into a collaborative development arrangement, the respective rights and obligations shall be documented before significant work begins wherever practicable.

12.7.4 Patents and Inventions

Where a project produces a potentially patentable invention, the creator or project team shall notify the designated College authority before publicly disclosing details that may affect protection.

The College may facilitate an initial assessment of the invention, including its originality, practical application, commercial potential, ownership, and possible protection requirements.

Where appropriate and subject to available resources, the College may assist with referrals to qualified intellectual-property professionals or relevant authorities, including the Kenya Industrial Property Institute (KIPI).

The College shall not represent that an invention is patentable until the relevant assessment and legal requirements have been addressed.

12.7.5 Copyright, Software, and Licensing

Copyright in software, research reports, learning materials, and other original works shall be handled in accordance with applicable law and any relevant agreements.

Project teams shall identify third-party software, open-source components, datasets, images, fonts, and other materials incorporated into their work and comply with the applicable licence terms.

Students and staff shall not claim ownership of another person's work or distribute proprietary materials without the required authorization.

12.7.6 Commercialization and Sharing of Benefits

Where an innovation generates income or is commercialized through an institutional partnership, the parties' rights, responsibilities, costs, revenue-sharing arrangements, and attribution requirements shall be documented in writing.

Any distribution of income shall comply with applicable law, institutional financial procedures, funding conditions, and the relevant agreement.

Disputes regarding ownership or commercialization shall be referred to College management for review and, where necessary, appropriate legal advice.

12.8 Partnerships and Industry Linkages

12.8.1 Purpose of Industry Partnerships

The College shall establish and maintain relationships with external organizations to strengthen the relevance, quality, and practical orientation of its training programmes.

Partnerships shall aim to improve access to workplace experience, technical expertise, research opportunities, professional mentorship, equipment, learning resources, and employment pathways.

12.8.2 Potential Partners

The College may collaborate with:

- ICT companies, software developers, internet service providers, and technology service firms.
- Accounting firms, audit firms, bookkeeping service providers, and tax consultancy firms.
- Universities, technical and vocational training institutions, and research organizations.
- Government ministries, departments, agencies, and county-level institutions.
- Banks, microfinance institutions, cooperatives, and other financial service providers.
- Small and medium-sized enterprises, entrepreneurs, and business associations.
- Non-governmental organizations, community-based organizations, and development partners.
- Professional bodies and other relevant public or private institutions.

The choice of partners shall be guided by relevance to the College's programmes, institutional objectives, legal compliance, mutual benefit, and the partner's capacity to support agreed activities.

12.8.3 Areas of Collaboration

Partnership activities include:

1. Industrial attachment and internship placement.
2. Guest lectures, seminars, workshops, and professional talks.
3. Joint research and innovation projects.
4. Mentorship and career guidance.
5. Access to industry-standard tools, software, equipment, and learning materials.
6. Technical visits, demonstrations, and workplace exposure.
7. Staff development and exchange of professional expertise.
8. Joint innovation challenges, competitions, and exhibitions.
9. Graduate recruitment and job placement support.
10. Consultancy, business development, and approved community projects.

12.8.4 Partnership Approval and Agreements

Formal partnerships shall be approved by the authorized College management representative.

Where necessary, the parties shall enter into a memorandum of understanding, service agreement, internship agreement, research agreement, or other appropriate written instrument.

The agreement should specify:

- The purpose and scope of the partnership.
- The responsibilities of each party.
- The expected activities, outputs, and duration.
- Financial obligations and resource contributions.
- Confidentiality and data-protection requirements.
- Intellectual-property ownership and permitted use.
- Health, safety, supervision, and insurance arrangements where applicable.
- Reporting, monitoring, dispute resolution, and termination procedures.

No staff member or student shall commit the College to a binding external partnership without the required authorization.

12.8.5 Partnership Monitoring

The College shall periodically assess whether partnerships are achieving their intended objectives.

Evaluation may consider the number of students placed, the quality of workplace learning, employer feedback, research outputs, joint projects, equipment or resource support, and employment outcomes.

Partnerships that no longer serve the College's objectives may be revised, suspended, or terminated in accordance with the relevant agreement.

12.9 Internship and Industrial Attachment Programmes

12.9.1 Purpose

The College shall promote workplace learning opportunities that enable students to apply classroom knowledge in real work environments.

Internships and industrial attachments are intended to improve technical competence, professional conduct, workplace communication, problem-solving, teamwork, and employability.

The College shall coordinate such programmes in accordance with relevant curriculum requirements, awarding-body rules, and applicable laws.

12.9.2 Identification of Placement Opportunities

The College may identify placement opportunities through formal industry partnerships, employer contacts, alumni networks, professional associations, government institutions, and other suitable organizations.

Placement decisions shall consider the student's programme, learning objectives, readiness for workplace duties, and the suitability of the host organization.

For ICT students, placements may be sought in software development, computer repair, networking, cybersecurity, data analysis, ICT support, digital design, and related fields.

For Accounting students, placements may be sought in bookkeeping, accounts departments, auditing, taxation, payroll, financial administration, and other relevant business functions.

12.9.3 Student Eligibility and Preparation

Students shall satisfy the applicable academic, administrative, and programme requirements before beginning an internship or industrial attachment.

Before placement, the College may provide orientation on:

- Workplace conduct and professional ethics.
- Communication and teamwork.
- Confidentiality and responsible data handling.
- Health and safety requirements.
- Attendance and reporting procedures.
- Appropriate use of workplace equipment and systems.
- Internship objectives, assessment, and documentation.

Students shall comply with the legitimate rules of the host organization while continuing to observe applicable College policies.

12.9.4 Responsibilities of the College

The College shall, within its available capacity:

1. Identify and communicate suitable placement opportunities.
2. Liaise with host organizations on placement requirements.
3. Provide students with placement documentation and guidance.
4. Assign a lecturer or designated officer to coordinate the programme.
5. Monitor student progress through reports, visits, calls, or other suitable methods.
6. Receive and review internship reports and employer evaluations.
7. Address placement difficulties and refer serious matters to the appropriate authority.
8. Use feedback from host organizations to improve training and curriculum relevance.

The College shall make reasonable efforts to facilitate placements but shall not guarantee a placement for every student unless expressly provided for in the relevant programme or agreement.

12.9.5 Responsibilities of Host Organizations

Where agreed, host organizations shall:

- Provide suitable work-related learning opportunities.
- Assign an appropriate workplace supervisor or mentor.
- Explain relevant workplace rules and safety procedures.
- Provide reasonable guidance and feedback on student performance.
- Notify the College of serious attendance, conduct, safety, or performance concerns.
- Respect applicable requirements concerning student welfare, confidentiality, and lawful workplace treatment.

The specific obligations of each host organization shall be governed by the applicable placement agreement and legal requirements.

12.9.6 Responsibilities of Students

Students undertaking internships or industrial attachment shall:

1. Attend the placement regularly and observe agreed working hours.
2. Perform assigned duties responsibly and honestly.
3. Maintain confidentiality of employer, customer, employee, and institutional information.
4. Protect workplace equipment, records, systems, and other resources.
5. Avoid unauthorized access to computer systems, financial records, or confidential information.
6. Maintain an internship logbook, work diary, or other required records.
7. Submit reports and evaluations within the required deadlines.
8. Notify the College and host supervisor of serious problems or safety concerns.
9. Comply with applicable workplace and College requirements.

Misconduct during placement may be addressed under the College's disciplinary procedures and any applicable host-organization rules.

12.9.7 Assessment of Internship Performance

Internship performance shall be assessed using:

- Attendance and punctuality.
- Professional conduct and teamwork.
- Practical skills and competence.
- Quality and completion of assigned tasks.
- Workplace supervisor evaluations.

- Student logbooks and reports.
- Oral presentations or assessment interviews.
- Compliance with programme-specific requirements.

The assessment process shall be consistent with the relevant curriculum and awarding-body requirements.

12.10 Job Placement and Career Development

12.10.1 Career Support Services

The College shall promote graduate employability through career guidance, employer engagement, mentorship, job information sharing, and other appropriate career development services.

Subject to available resources, the College shall provide:

- CV and résumé preparation assistance.
- Interview preparation and mock interviews.
- Guidance on job applications and professional communication.
- Information about employment opportunities and internships.
- Entrepreneurship and self-employment guidance.
- Professional networking opportunities.
- Information on relevant certifications and further training.

12.10.2 Employer Engagement

The College may maintain contact with employers to identify emerging skills requirements and share information about graduates' competencies.

Employers may be invited to participate in career talks, recruitment events, skills demonstrations, advisory discussions, and other approved institutional activities.

The College shall use employer feedback to identify skills gaps and recommend appropriate improvements to training programmes.

12.10.3 Graduate and Alumni Networks

The College has established and maintained an alumni network to support professional networking, mentorship, employment referrals, entrepreneurship, and institutional development.

Alumni participation shall be voluntary and shall respect applicable data-protection requirements.

The College may maintain graduate destination information to assess employment, self-employment, further training, and other outcomes, subject to appropriate consent or another lawful basis for processing the information.

12.10.4 Fairness in Job Placement

Employment referrals and placement support shall be conducted fairly and transparently.

The College shall not guarantee employment where it has no authority to do so, misrepresent graduates' qualifications, or provide misleading information to prospective employers.

Employers shall remain responsible for their recruitment decisions, employment terms, and compliance with applicable employment laws.

12.11 Research Funding and Resource Mobilization

12.11.1 Funding Sources

The College may support approved research and innovation through its institutional budget, project fees where applicable, grants, donations, sponsorships, research partnerships, and other lawful sources of funding.

Funding proposals shall be assessed according to their educational value, feasibility, budget requirements, expected outcomes, and compliance with institutional priorities.

12.11.2 Budgeting and Expenditure

Each funded project shall have an appropriate budget and expenditure approval process.

Project funds shall be used only for authorized purposes and managed in accordance with the College's Finance and Procurement Policy and any applicable donor or partner conditions.

Receipts, invoices, payment records, and other supporting documents shall be maintained as required.

12.11.3 External Funding Conditions

Where a project receives external funding, the College and project team shall comply with the relevant grant or sponsorship agreement.

Funding agreements shall be reviewed for provisions concerning reporting, ownership of outputs, publication rights, confidentiality, financial accountability, and permitted expenditure.

Any agreement that creates significant legal, financial, or intellectual-property obligations shall be reviewed and approved by the appropriate College authority before acceptance.

12.12 Publication, Dissemination, and Knowledge Sharing

The College shall encourage the responsible sharing of research findings and innovation outcomes through appropriate channels.

These includes:

- Student research reports and project demonstrations.
- Academic presentations and seminars.
- Institutional publications and approved online platforms.
- Innovation exhibitions and competitions.
- Industry workshops and stakeholder meetings.
- Articles, technical reports, and other suitable publications.

Before information is published or publicly presented, the responsible team shall consider confidentiality obligations, personal-data protection, third-party rights, intellectual-property protection, and any applicable partner agreements.

Where public disclosure may affect a potential patent or other form of protection, the College shall consider the timing of publication and seek appropriate advice where necessary.

Research findings shall be presented honestly, and limitations or uncertainties shall not be deliberately concealed.

12.13 Conflict of Interest and Professional Conduct

Students and staff involved in research, innovation, or industry partnerships shall disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest that could improperly influence project decisions, assessment, procurement, recruitment, or the use of institutional resources.

No person shall use a College partnership to obtain unauthorized personal benefits, misuse confidential information, or improperly favour a business or individual.

Any gifts, sponsorships, commissions, or financial interests connected to a College-supported project shall be handled in accordance with the College's financial, procurement, and ethical requirements.

The College shall address conflicts fairly and take reasonable steps to protect the integrity and reputation of its research and partnership activities.

12.14 Monitoring, Evaluation, and Reporting

The College shall periodically evaluate its research, innovation, and industry linkage activities to determine whether they are achieving their intended objectives.

Monitoring indicators may include:

1. Number of research and innovation projects initiated and completed.
2. Number of student projects demonstrating practical or commercial potential.
3. Number and quality of active industry partnerships.
4. Number of students undertaking internships or industrial attachments.

5. Employer satisfaction with student and graduate competencies.
6. Number of graduates accessing employment, self-employment, or further training.
7. Research publications, presentations, exhibitions, and innovation awards.
8. External funding secured for approved projects.
9. Intellectual-property disclosures, registrations, licences, or commercialization outcomes.
10. Student, staff, and partner feedback.

The designated officer or relevant department shall prepare periodic reports for College management. Findings shall be used to improve project supervision, industry engagement, student support, and the relevance of training programmes.

12.15 Roles and Responsibilities

Office or Stakeholder	Key Responsibilities
College Management	Approve policy, partnerships, budgets, major research activities, and institutional agreements
Academic Department Heads	Identify research priorities, coordinate projects, and monitor academic relevance
Project Supervisors	Guide students, review progress, support ethical conduct, and assess project outputs
Research and Innovation Coordinator, if appointed	Coordinate research activities, partnerships, records, and innovation initiatives
ICT Department or ICT Trainers	Support ICT projects, technical innovation, software use, and authorized system development
Accounting Department or Accounting Trainers	Support accounting research, financial analysis, bookkeeping projects, and industry engagement
Internship/Placement Coordinator	Facilitate placements, liaise with employers, monitor progress, and maintain records
Students	Conduct responsible research, protect resources, document work, and comply with project requirements
Industry Partners	Provide agreed mentorship, workplace learning, technical input, or other partnership support
Alumni and Employers	Provide career guidance, industry feedback, mentorship, and employment-related engagement where appropriate

Where the College has limited staffing, management may assign these responsibilities to existing officers rather than establishing separate departments.

12.16 Policy Compliance and Enforcement

All research, innovation, and industry linkage activities shall comply with this policy, applicable academic regulations, financial procedures, intellectual-property requirements, data-protection obligations, and other relevant institutional rules.

Violations may include research misconduct, plagiarism, unauthorized use of College resources, breach of confidentiality, misuse of project funds, unauthorized disclosure of protected information, and failure to comply with approved partnership arrangements.

Depending on the nature and seriousness of the violation, the College may issue corrective instructions, suspend project activities, restrict access to resources, refer the matter for disciplinary action, or pursue other lawful remedies.

All reported violations shall be handled fairly, proportionately, and in accordance with the relevant institutional procedures.

12.17 Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed periodically by College management in consultation with relevant departments and stakeholders.

Reviews shall consider changes in ICT and Accounting industries, emerging technologies, employment trends, research practices, applicable legislation, institutional capacity, and feedback from students, staff, employers, and partners.

Amendments shall be approved through the College's established policy review and approval procedures.

12.18 Expected Outcomes

Implementation of this policy is expected to achieve the following outcomes:

- Increased student participation in practical research and innovation.
- Improved alignment between College training and industry requirements.
- Stronger partnerships with ICT firms, accounting firms, universities, government bodies, and businesses.
- Better access to internships, industrial attachments, mentorship, and employment opportunities.
- Improved student and graduate technical, analytical, entrepreneurial, and professional competencies.
- Responsible management and protection of intellectual property.
- Increased opportunities for developing useful digital products, accounting solutions, and business innovations.
- Improved accountability in research funding and project management.
- Stronger contribution to local enterprise development and community problem-solving.
- Continuous improvement in the quality, relevance, and reputation of RuralNet Training College.

Implementation recommendation: RuralNet Training College should designate a staff member to coordinate research, innovation, and industry linkages, even if a separate department is not yet practical. The College should also develop standard templates for research proposals, project approval, intellectual-property declarations, partnership agreements, internship logbooks, employer evaluations, and project completion reports. These will make the policy easier to implement consistently across both ICT and Accounting programmes.